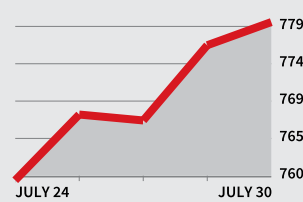


the hindu businessline

SENSEX 77928.15 (+273.55)



IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	24317.15	+66.95
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	20.88	+0.05
US Dollar (in ₹)	95.68	+0.04
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	142810.00	+1156
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	218665.00	+1310



LOSING SHEEN.

Demand for gold falls as volatile prices of yellow metal turn consumers away in the second quarter this year: WGC **p10**

STEPPING ON THE PEDAL.

Petrol would have cost 125/litre in March-April without ethanol blending, says Nitin Gadkari **p3**

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QUICKLY.

NOW FOR PLAN B

Zepto puts IPO on hold, to raise over ₹1,000 cr



Bengaluru: Quick commerce firm Zepto has put its IPO plans on hold for now, and has instead begun work on raising more than ₹1,000 crore through a pre-IPO placement, according to people familiar with the matter. The funding round is expected to see participation primarily by existing investors, with domestic institutional investors likely to lead the round. **p6**

ALL ROUND GROWTH

Mahindra & Mahindra profit jumps 34% in Q1

Mumbai: Mahindra & Mahindra on Thursday reported a 34 per cent year-on-year rise in consolidated net profit attributable to owners at ₹5,455 crore in Q1, while revenue increased 28 per cent to ₹58,188 crore on growth across automotive, farm equipment and services businesses. **p2**

Windfall dividends, divestment receipts give govt fiscal cushion

ELBOW ROOM. Payouts by RBI, PSBs top full-year Budget Estimate of ₹3.16 lakh crore

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

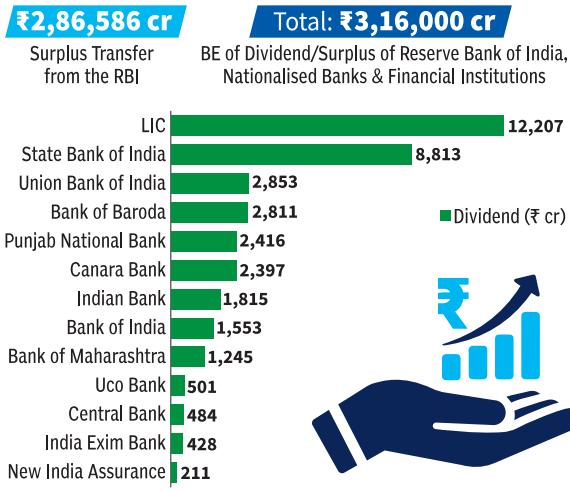
Higher-than-expected dividend and surplus payouts by the Reserve Bank of India and state-run financial institutions have provided the Centre much-needed fiscal elbow room. Total collections under this head have already outpaced the full-year Budget Estimate (BE) of ₹3.16 lakh crore, possibly blunting the impact of an anticipated moderation in direct tax buoyancy.

LIC DIVIDEND

The BE for 'dividend/surplus of the Reserve Bank of India, nationalised banks and financial institutions' had been pegged at ₹3.16 lakh crore, which is nearly 47 per cent of the non-tax revenue of over ₹6.66 lakh crore. As of July 30, total collections under this head topped ₹3.24 lakh crore after the Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC) gave the government a dividend of over ₹12,000 crore for FY26.

Collections under the

Boost to exchequer



head got off to a strong start, anchored by a record surplus transfer of ₹2.87 lakh crore by the RBI. This was followed by good payouts by public sector banks and insurance companies.

SBI LEADS

While the LIC topped the dividend payouts among public financial institutions, the State Bank of India led the

10 PSBs that have remitted dividends to the Centre so far.

Public sector banks are required to pay a minimum dividend of 20 per cent of their paid-up capital, or 20 per cent of their post-tax profits, whichever is higher. For public sector insurance companies, there is no specific limit.

For example, the dividend distribution policy of the

Drug quality norms tightened, push on for biomed: Pharma Secretary

bl.interview

Ankita Upadhyay
New Delhi

The Centre has begun cracking down on pharmaceutical manufacturers that fail to meet revised quality standards, with non-compliant companies being asked to shut down unless they upgrade their facilities, said Manoj Joshi, Secretary, Department of Pharmaceuticals.

MAIN PRIORITY.

In an interview, Joshi said that restoring confidence in India's pharmaceutical manufacturing through stricter regulation is the government's immediate priority. "The revised Schedule M became mandatory from January 1. Companies that do not comply with the revised WHO-GMP standards are being asked to shut down unless they upgrade. Non-compliant companies are also not eligible for government tenders," he said, adding that regulatory no-objection certificates (NOCs) are now mandatory for the export of certain medicines not sold in India.

On the global surge in



Manoj Joshi, Secretary, Dept of Pharmaceuticals

GLP-1 weight-loss drugs such as semaglutide, Joshi said that four or five companies are already manufacturing them in India, while others import or source them domestically.

"Misuse is a matter for the Health Department. Counterfeit drugs remain a concern and the CDSCO, State regulators and the police are taking continuous action," he said.

Looking ahead, Joshi identified three priorities for keeping India the pharmacy of the world — building a stronger ecosystem for biological drugs, reducing dependence on imported bulk drugs and improving drug quality through tighter surveillance and enforcement.

On medicine prices, he said essential drugs remain under price control, while

trade margin rationalisation for expensive medicines is under consideration.

"The prices of essential medicines cannot rise by more than 10 per cent a year. But any cap on trade margins has to be balanced, as it could affect supplies of cheaper medicines in rural areas," he said.

On industry demands for price hikes due to higher input costs, Joshi said only evidence-backed requests would be considered. "The NPPA is examining cases supported by data, particularly where API prices have risen significantly. Many companies have made only general requests."

PRICE CONTROL

Joshi also rejected the argument that price controls have hurt innovation. "Around 80 per cent of medicines are already outside price control. The bigger issue is that Indian companies under-invest in R&D because markets often treat it as an expense rather than an investment," he said.

On the Jan Aushadhi scheme, Joshi said the government plans to add more medical devices and some OTC products.

Interview on p12

Sarvam AI to build trillion parameter model

Sanjana B
Bengaluru

India's full-stack sovereign AI company Sarvam AI on Thursday unveiled plans to build a trillion-plus parameter foundational model, and launched a suite of new AI products and developer tools as it sharpens its ambitions to become a full-stack AI platform.

Speaking at the company's Sarvam EPOCH event, Co-Founder Pratyush Kumar said the company is scaling its model-building capabilities to compete with leading global AI companies.

"We are investing in trillion-plus parameter models from scratch to be competitive across coding, cybersecurity, simulation, science and other tasks," he said, adding that the model is likely to be ready in six months.

The company said it plans to significantly expand its compute infrastructure and training capabilities, building on its experience of training large models in India.

As part of its global expansion strategy, Sarvam had earlier announced the opening of a San Francisco office to tap into the world's largest AI talent pool.

"We want to have a very strong conduit of talent back to India. It is important to get the best people thinking and building for the Indian context," Kumar said.

PRICING STRATEGY

According to Sarvam, its 105-billion-parameter model delivers competitive performance with leading open- and closed-source frontier models of a similar class across knowledge, reasoning and agentic benchmarks.

The company said the

model also outperforms peers on Indian-language benchmarks, while demonstrating strong capabilities in mathematics, coding and instruction-following tasks.

The company also highlighted the pricing of its latest models, saying its 105-billion-parameter model is priced at \$0.80 per one million blended tokens, compared with \$4.5 for GPT-5.4 Mini and \$9 for Gemini 3.5 Flash, offering a cost advantage of more than 5x and 11x.

SLEW OF PRODUCTS

The start-up unveiled a range of products spanning enterprise AI, developer tools and multimodal AI capabilities.

Among the launches were Sarvam Code, an AI coding assistant; Saaras V4, a multilingual speech recognition model; Bulbul V4, a multilingual text-to-speech model; and broader availability of its

Voice Agents platform for developers.

Kumar said that the company's strategy extends beyond building frontier models to creating an end-to-end AI ecosystem.

"We want to produce the largest share of AI tokens consumed in India right here."

He added that the goal is to enable developers and enterprises access frontier AI models hosted in India with strong data security and globally competitive pricing.

The announcements follow Sarvam's \$234 million first close of its \$300 million Series B round in June, which valued the company at \$1.5 billion post-money.

Sarvam builds across the AI stack: Training and inference infrastructure, frontier model research and a go-to-market motion spanning enterprises, developers and government.

Kalyan's new brand 'ATM' looks to cash in on Tamil Nadu's love for gold jewellery

Sindhu Hariharan
Chennai

From a single store in Thirsur to a pan-India empire, Kalyan Jewellers spent decades conquering the national stage, but has now spotted a golden opportunity in a hyper-local regional market.

To conquer Tamil Nadu, said to be India's biggest gold jewellery consuming State, Kalyan has launched a new brand Akshaya Thanga Maligai (ATM), which will take on the State's legacy jewellers on their own turf.

ATM is all set to make a glittering debut with its first showroom, a massive 25,000 sq ft space, at Chennai's most prominent jewellery retail hub — Panagal Park — in T Nagar. Over the next six months, four more ATM stores will open in the State, disclosed Ramesh Kalyanaraman, Executive Director, Kalyan Jewellers India. The jewellery giant is



The jewellery market has evolved into distinct segments, and regional markets offer significant opportunities

RAMESH KALYANARAMAN
ED, Kalyan Jewellers

investing ₹300 crore this financial year on ATM, which will be its third brand after Kalyan and Candere.

The company has already launched teaser campaigns in Chennai, featuring Kollywood star Sivakarthikeyan, asking customers to watch out for an ATM that now gives jewellery.

"It's a fun name and marketing device," said independent strategy consultant Toru Jhaveri.

GOLDEN OPPORTUNITY
On the need for a separate



brand for the State, Kalyanaraman said that the organised jewellery market had now evolved into multiple distinct segments, and regional markets offer significant opportunities.

"Right from the name, the inventory, the campaigns, the staff and other aspects, everything will be 100 per cent Tamil," he said.

The inventory is also curated specifically for the State's preferences in terms of designs, weights, price-points and buying occasions, he said. "Every State has a

distinct preference in chains, bangles, necklaces and other products, making localisation important," he said.

Interestingly, while ATM is backed by Kalyan's scale, sourcing and quality-assurance, the company does not plan to lean on its national brand to promote ATM. "This brand stands by itself," he said.

SOUND STRATEGY

Jhaveri said that having a separate brand for a State that has disproportionate share of consumption in a category is a sound strategy, especially when consumers elsewhere are being "skitish" about purchasing gold.

She said that that gold jewellery consumers in Tamil Nadu seek a very distinct kind of purchase experience with the entire family participating. "So, apart from the design preferences, even the retail experiences have to be tailored differently," she pointed out.



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QUICKLY.

Honda Cars appoints new President, CEO from Oct 1



New Delhi: Honda Cars India said it has appointed Toshiyuki Yanagisawa as the new President and CEO, effective October 1, replacing Takashi Nakajima, who is moving to the regional headquarters in Asian Honda Motor Co, after his India tenure. **OUR BUREAU**

IMPAL reports 10% increase in PAT in Q1

Chennai: The Chennai-based India Motor Parts and Accessories (IMPAL) reported a 10 per cent increase in standalone net profit to ₹22 crore for Q1FY27 as against ₹20 crore for the year-ago quarter. Revenue was up 19 per cent to ₹234 crore (₹197 crore), according to data filed by the company in the stock exchanges. **OUR BUREAU**

Tata Steel net profit up 19% in Q1 on better realisation

CHALLENGING TIMES. Global operating environment remains complex, says CEO & MD

Our Bureau

Mumbai

Tata Steel has reported that its net profit in the June quarter was up 19 per cent at ₹2,385 crore compared with ₹2,007 crore logged in the same period last year, on higher realisation.

Revenue increased 14 per cent to ₹60,794 crore (₹53,178 crore).

Sales volume was up 2 per cent at 7.27 million tonne (7.12 mt).

EBITDA was up 25 per cent at ₹9,370 crore (₹7,480 crore), while EBITDA per tonne jumped 23 per cent to ₹12,898 (₹10,503).

NOD FOR EXPANSION

The board has approved investment of ₹33,873 crore to expand the long steel making capacity by 4.8 mtpa at Neelachal Ispat Nigam in Odisha.

The move will enable Tata Steel to further expand the



long products portfolio, especially in the retail space where its branded products are in high demand.

The company has spent ₹3,579 crore on capital expenditure in the quarter. The 0.75-mtpa electric arc furnace plant at Ludhiana is ramping up and construction is in progress for the 0.7-mtpa Hot Rolled Pickling and Galvanising Line, along with Phase 1 expansion of Timpale from 0.4 mtpa to 0.7 mtpa.

STRONG LIQUIDITY

Gross debt increased to ₹97,985 crore. The group's liquidity remains strong at ₹45,950 crore, which includes cash & cash equivalent

Scorecard (in ₹ cr)			
	Q1FY26	Q1FY27	
Net profit	2,007	2,385	
Revenue	53,178	60,794	
EPS (₹) diluted	1.67	1.86	

ents of ₹13,221 crore.

On a standalone basis, the company's revenue was at ₹36,989 crore (₹31,137 crore) and EBITDA was ₹9,409 crore (₹7,263 crore). EBITDA per tonne improved to ₹18,198 (₹15,289).

The local environment authority has permitted Tata Steel Netherlands to carry out trial runs, which are ongoing, ahead of the restart of full operations.

WEST ASIA CRISIS

TV Narendran, Chief Executive Officer & Managing Director, said global operating environment remained complex, with the impact of developments in West Asia on supply chains and input

costs being more pronounced in the quarter.

The company's overseas operations also had to navigate operational disruptions, he said.

The e-commerce platforms, Aashiyana and DigECA, generated Gross Merchandise Value of about ₹2,200 crore, up 61 per cent.

"We also strengthened our presence in emerging segments such as shipbuilding, data centres and containers," he added.

UK LOSS NARROWS

Koushik Chatterjee, Executive Director & CFO, said the UK operations narrowed its EBITDA loss from £48 million in Q4 to £27 million in Q1, reflecting the impact of targeted improvement initiatives and better pricing supported by trade measures.

Working capital was impacted by inventory build due to operational and supply chain disruptions, and an increase in prices, he said.

West Asia crisis, Chennai plant fire drag Hyundai Motor India's Q1 PAT

S Ronendra Singh

New Delhi

Impacted by a fire incident near its facility in Chennai and the West Asia crisis, Hyundai Motor India (HMI), on Thursday, reported decline in net profit as well as revenue from operations, respectively, during Q1 FY27.

Net profit declined 35.1 per cent year-on-year to ₹886.6 crore compared with ₹1,369.2 crore in the year-ago quarter. Revenue from operations declined 0.5 per cent to ₹16,334.6 crore (₹16,413 crore).

Speaking to mediapersons at an earnings call, Tarun Garg, MD and CEO, HMI, said, "We lost 13,900 vehicles in June, and most of it has already been recovered in July. And, of course, within Q2, 100 per cent of it will be recovered; coupled with healthy demand environment and upcoming product pipeline, recovery is likely to gain pace from Q2 across both domestic and export businesses," he said.

MULTIPLE HEADWINDS

He said Q1 FY27 was a chal-

Bumpy road

	Q1FY26	Q1FY27	% change
Net profit (₹ crore)	1,369.2	886.6	-35.1
Revenue (₹ crore)	16,412.9	16,334.6	-0.5
Total sales volume (units)	1,80,399	1,78,082	-1.3

lenging quarter with multiple headwinds impacting volumes and profitability.

"Looking ahead, we remain committed to achieving our stated guidance of 8-10 per cent volume growth for both domestic and exports as well as 11-14 per cent EBITDA margin in FY27," he added.

During the quarter, HMI sold a total of 1,78,082 units (1,80,399 units), down 1.3 per cent.

In the domestic market, it reported growth of 5.4 per cent to 1,39,374 units (1,32,259 units).

Exports were down 19.6 per cent at 38,708 units (48,140 units).

"The US-Iran conflict, which started towards the end of the last fiscal, continued to impact our West Asia exports during Q1 of FY27. Export volumes were also affected by the temporary pro-

duction disruption in June," Garg said.

CAPEX PLANS

When asked about capex for the ongoing fiscal, the company said it will be about ₹7,500 crore.

Of this, 45-50 per cent would go in for products, especially for the upcoming two new models; another 30 per cent on plant-related activities, including Phase 2 capacity expansion for Pune and upgradation of the Chennai plant.

Garg said network is being expanded across India with six out of 10 outlets being given in the rural areas, and two new products also coming — one in high-volume segments, the mid SUV in festive season — as well as the new electric vehicle within this fiscal year that would drive the company's volumes.

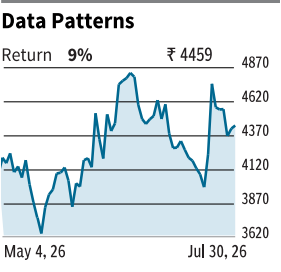
Data Patterns to acquire ST Advanced Composites; Q1 PAT down 14%

Our Bureau

Chennai

The board of directors of defence and aerospace electronics solutions provider Data Patterns approved a proposal, on Thursday, for the full acquisition of Chennai-based composite manufacturing company, ST Advanced Composites Pvt Ltd (STAC), for a total consideration of ₹10 crore.

The acquisition will result in an in-house capability for composite parts required in the company's radar and other programmes, while also expanding the address-



able value proposition in Data Patterns' product offerings, it said in a media release.

Q1 FY27 RESULTS

Data Patterns reported a 14 per cent dip in net profit for Q1 FY27 at ₹22 crore as

against ₹25.5 crore in the same quarter last year.

The firm's revenue from operations went up 17 per cent to ₹116 crore.

"The quarter has met our expectations. Order inflow has been encouraging since the start of the financial year, with over ₹226 crore in orders received so far and more in the pipeline. While revenue for the quarter was modest, primarily due to temporary delays in customer approvals, these are expected to normalise in the coming quarters," Srinivasagopalan Rangarajan, Chairman and Managing Director, Data Patterns (India), said.

Sundaram Home Finance Q1 net profit up 37% at ₹85 cr

Our Bureau

Chennai

Sundaram Home Finance registered a 37 per cent increase in net profit for Q1 FY27 at ₹85 crore compared to ₹62 crore in the same quarter of the previous year.

Disbursements for the quarter went up 12 per cent to ₹1,665 crore (₹1,488 crore).

Assets under management stood at ₹20,325 crore as of June 2026, an 11 per cent year-on-year rise.

Disbursements in the emerging business segment comprising small ticket loans and affordable housing

finance stood at ₹180 crore (₹83 crore).

GROWTH DRIVERS

"Economic development in smaller towns is driving rising home ownership and improving affordability, and this is opening up strong growth opportunities for us. Our emerging business segment has scaled up nicely, with our expansion across the southern States helping us register healthy growth in the segment in the first quarter," D Lakshminarayana, MD, Sundaram Home Finance, said.

Sundaram Home Finance is the wholly-owned subsidiary of Sundaram Finance.

JB Pharma integration, higher finance costs weigh on Torrent's Q1 PAT

Our Bureau

Ahmedabad

Torrent Pharmaceuticals reported a modest 3.3 per cent year-on-year increase in consolidated net profit for Q1 of FY27 as higher finance costs, depreciation and one-time integration-related expenses linked to the JB Pharma acquisition offset the benefit of a sharp rise in revenue.

The company reported a consolidated PAT of ₹566 crore (₹548 crore), while revenue from operations surged 55 per cent to ₹4,921 crore, driven primarily by the inclusion of JB Pharma. Operating EBITDA before

exceptional items rose 61 per cent to ₹1,664 crore, with margin improving to 33.8 per cent (32.5 per cent).

EXCEPTIONAL ITEMS

The quarter included ₹21 crore of exceptional expenses, comprising regulatory and statutory costs related to the JB Pharma acquisition and merger as well as inventory write-offs following a fire at an erstwhile JB Pharma warehouse. The company also absorbed higher depreciation and finance costs following the acquisition, limiting growth in the bottom line despite strong operating performance.

Excluding JB Pharma, Torrent's standalone business continued to post healthy growth, with revenue rising 17 per cent to ₹3,720 crore and operating EBITDA increasing 20 per cent to ₹1,240 crore. India remained the biggest growth driver, with revenue rising 19 per cent to ₹2,157 crore, outperforming the domestic pharmaceutical market's 12 per cent growth, according to AIOCD Pharmatrac data.

Torrent said it is now ranked No 1 in the Indian cardiac market, while its generic semaglutide franchise captured a 36 per cent market share across oral and injectable formulations.

M&M Q1 attributable profit up 34% to ₹5,455 cr

Amit Vijay Mohile

Mumbai

Mahindra & Mahindra on Thursday reported a 34 per cent year-on-year rise in consolidated net profit attributable to owners to ₹5,455 crore for Q1 FY27, while consolidated revenue increased 28 per cent to ₹58,188 crore, as broad-based growth across its automotive, farm equipment and services businesses helped it outperform Street expectations.

The diversified group delivered robust growth across businesses, prompting Group CEO and Managing Director Anish Shah to describe it as a "strong start to FY27 despite a quarter marked by macro headwinds".

AUTO DRIVES GROWTH

The automotive business remained the largest contributor to earnings, with con-

Scorecard (₹ cr)			
	Q1FY26	Q1FY27	% change
Revenue from operations (M&M Consolidated)	45,529.2	58,188	28
Net Profit Attributable to Owners (*M&M Consolidated)	4,083.3	5,455	34
Revenue (*Auto)	25,999	34,387	32
PAT(*Auto)	1,760	2,129	21
Revenue (*Farm)	10,892	12,501	15
PAT (*Farm)	1,323	1,520	15

Source : Company filing

*Business

solidated revenue rising 32 per cent to ₹34,387 crore and profit increasing 21 per cent to ₹2,129 crore. Vehicle volumes rose 23 per cent to 3,04,000 units, including a 15 per cent increase in SUV sales, helping M&M retain its 25 per cent SUV revenue market share. Standalone automotive PBIT margin moderated to 7.1 per cent, or 8.3 per cent excluding eSUV contract manufacturing, reflecting commodity inflation and investments in electric mobility.

Rajesh Jejurikar, Execut-

ive Director and CEO (Auto & Farm Sector), said the company expanded SUV revenue market share by 50 basis points during the quarter, while the XEV 9e emerged as India's highest-selling electric SUV by volume. Despite inflationary pressures, the core tractor business maintained a PBIT margin of 19.2 per cent, he said.

OTHER BUSINESSES

The farm equipment business continued its strong run, with tractor volumes

rising 18 per cent to 1,58,000 units and market share improving to 44.9 per cent. Revenue and profit each grew 15 per cent, although margins softened because of higher input costs.

The group's services businesses provided another leg of growth. Mahindra Finance expanded assets under management by 13 per cent, while Tech Mahindra improved EBIT margin by 330 basis points. Mahindra Logistics reported 23 per cent revenue growth and a three-fold jump in profit, helping consolidated services revenue rise 31 per cent and profit increase 80 per cent.

STREET FOCUS

While the headline earnings exceeded expectations, investors are likely to focus on the sustainability of automotive margins, the trajectory of commodity costs and the pace of electric-vehicle investments over the coming quarters.

India can become world's 'connector economy' as global order shifts, says Anand Mahindra

Amit Vijay Mohile

Mumbai

India should position itself as a global "connector economy," as the world moves away from traditional globalisation towards selective partnerships and regional supply chains, Anand Mahindra, Chairman of Mahindra & Mahindra, said on Thursday.

He added that the group is backing that vision with deeper investments in innovation and manufacturing, including a proposed ₹15,000 crore investment in Nagpur over the next decade and a sharp increase in its patent portfolio.

Addressing shareholders at the company's 80th annual general meeting, Mahindra said countries that combine manufacturing scale, political stability, talent and trust

would emerge as preferred partners as businesses diversify supply chains and reduce geopolitical risks.

India, he said, is uniquely placed to benefit from that transition.

"The next global order may not be built around very rigid blocks. It may be built around multiple coalitions, around countries that can connect rather than divide. And that creates a major opportunity for India to become what I call a connector economy," he said.

MULTI-ALIGNED INDIA

Mahindra said that India's role was evolving beyond its traditional policy of non-alignment to what he termed as a "multi-aligned" approach, enabling it to deepen economic and strategic partnerships across regions.

"It's not about being non-aligned, but about being



It's not about being non-aligned, but about being multi-aligned

ANAND MAHINDRA, Chairman, Mahindra & Mahindra

multi-aligned, about being a trusted partner across the world," he said, adding that the challenge was no longer whether India would rise, but how effectively it could convert the current geopolitical moment into lasting

competitive advantage.

BUILD CAPABILITIES

As evidence of India's growing role in global manufacturing, Mahindra pointed to the increasing localisation of global production, noting that around one-fourth of all iPhones were now manufactured in India.

That, he said, reflected the country's growing credibility as a manufacturing and investment destination in an uncertain world.

Mahindra briefly referred to the "Samudra Manthan" analogy from last year's shareholder letter, saying that the churn in the global economy had become more structural than cyclical. But he argued that the environment favoured countries and companies prepared to adapt quickly and build long-term capabilities rather than wait for uncertainty to fade.

Go Fashion net profit down 26%

Rohan Das

Chennai

Chennai-headquartered Go Fashion (India) reported a net profit of ₹16.4 crore for the quarter ended March 2026, down 26 per cent, as against ₹22.2 crore in the corresponding quarter last year. Revenue from operations stood at ₹231 crore (₹228 crore).

The performance for the quarter was impacted by a one-time write-off of property, plant and equipment of around ₹6.5 crore related to store closures. The listed fashion retailer, with a focus on bottom wear, has been in a transitional phase since Q4 FY26, wherein it has been closing smaller-sized Exclusive Brand Outlets (EBOs) and launching larger 700-800-sq-ft stores to support broader everyday wear and



Gautam Saraogi, Founder & CEO, Go Fashion

non-leggings product lines.

Speaking to *businessline*, Gautam Saraogi, Founder & CEO, Go Fashion, said the company closed approximately 60-65 stores in Q1FY27 and opened about 14. He added that 50-55 smaller stores were being consolidated into large-format EBOs, while the remaining involved relocation of stores to better micro

markets. "There will be a few more closures in Q2 and Q3, but it will not be to the same extent, as much of the consolidation phase is now behind us," he said.

CHANNEL MIX

As for the channel mix, Saraogi said both EBOs and Large Format Stores (LFS), which together account for more than 90 per cent of the company's sales, grew 2 per cent, while the Multi Brand Outlet (MBO) saw a sharp fall of 40 per cent. "The entire MBO market has been a little bit of a struggle for us. But our two main primary channels, which are EBO and LFS, have given us consistent growth rates," he said.

Online sales contributed to 3.6 per cent of Go Fashion's sales in Q1 and Saraogi said there are long-term aspirations to take its share to 10 per cent.

Fourth plant takes Maruti's capacity in Gujarat facility to 10 lakh units

S Ronendra Singh

New Delhi

Maruti Suzuki India (MSIL) on Thursday said that it has commenced commercial production at the fourth plant (Plant D) of its Hansalpur facility in Gujarat, marking the first time in Suzuki's history that the total annual production capacity at a single manufacturing facility has reached 10 lakh units.

The fourth plant, with annual capacity of 2.5 lakh units, enhanced the Hansalpur facility's total annual production capacity from 7.5 lakh units to 10 lakh units, the company said.

HANSALPUR FACILITY

MSIL said that it also makes Addedalspur facility India's largest passenger vehicle manufacturing facil-



MORE CAPACITY. MSIL said that the new plant will initially produce its flagship battery electric vehicle, e Vitara

ity at a single location. With Hansalpur Plant D, MSIL's total manufacturing capacity stands at 29 lakh units per

investment of ₹3,900 crore for Plant D.

The new plant will initially produce the company's flagship Battery Electric Vehicle (BEV), the e Vitara, MSIL said.

MANUFACTURING HUB

"Gujarat has emerged as a manufacturing and export hub for Maruti Suzuki, backed by strong infrastructure and a progressive industrial ecosystem. The new line will further strengthen our ability to meet the growing demand from customers in India and overseas while advancing our 'Make in India, Make for the World' vision and expanding our global footprint," Hisashi Takeuchi, MD and CEO, MSIL, said.

The state-of-the-art Hansalpur facility produces Fronx, Baleno, Swift and e Vitara, and the facility has emerged as a major export

hub for the company, accounting for nearly 47 per cent of its overall overseas shipments in FY26, he said.

"Together, the Hansalpur and the upcoming Sanand facility in Gujarat will play a pivotal role in achieving our long-term ambition of producing four million units annually in India. These projects reflect our commitment to strengthening India's manufacturing competitiveness, creating employment and boosting exports," Takeuchi added.

businessline.

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FTA monitoring panel to review utilisation of 16 pacts in August

TRADE ASSESSMENT. Committee will discuss the impediments faced by industry

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

The Commerce Department's FTA monitoring committee is scheduled to meet in August to undertake a comprehensive review of the implementation of the country's 16 operational trade agreements, including the recently implemented pacts with the UK and Oman, and identify the challenges faced by exporters in using the concessions they offer.

"The government is seeking detailed feedback from industry on the impediments in utilising the different FTAs. Sector-wise inputs are being collected so that the issues can be addressed," a source told *businessline*.

Of the 16 trade pacts implemented so far by the country, 10 were implemented before the BJP government came to power in 2014.



TAKING STOCK. The FTA monitoring committee's review assumes significance as India pursues a strategy of signing comprehensive trade agreements with advanced economies

These include the India-Sri Lanka FTA, the Agreement on Safta, the India Nepal Treaty of Trade, the India-Bhutan Agreement on Trade Commerce and Transit, the India-Thailand FTA - Early Harvest Scheme, the India-Singapore CECA, the India-Asean CECA, the India-Malaysia CECA, the India-South Korea CEPA, and the India-Japan CEPA.

The ones signed by the present government are the

India-Mauritius CECPA, the India-UAE CEPA, the India-Oman CEPA, the India-Australia ECTA, the India-EFTA (Switzerland, Iceland, Liechtenstein, Norway) TEPA and the India-UK CETA.

FTA UTILISATION
A range of factors was flagged by industry that limit FTA utilisation. "The problems include the complex and stringent rules of origin that determine eligibility for

preferential tariffs, especially the product specific rules, the cumbersome documentation and certification requirements, limited awareness among exporters, particularly MSMEs, and increasingly demanding technical regulations, sanitary and phytosanitary measures and quality standards in partner countries," an industry source said.

India's overall FTA utilisation has been historically very low. "Only an estimated 20-30 per cent of India's eligible exports take advantage of FTA preferences. Many small firms prefer to avoid the compliance burden for modest tariff savings," according to a 2026 report on FTA challenges by GTRI.

The FTA monitoring committee's review assumes significance as India pursues an ambitious strategy of signing comprehensive trade pacts with advanced economies.

'India-EU free trade pact has work plan built in to address CBAM concerns'

Amiti Sen
New Delhi



The pact provides for cooperation on verification of embedded carbon emissions and recognition of verifiers

A comprehensive work plan built into the India-European Union free trade agreement (FTA) could help address concerns of Indian exporters, particularly small and medium enterprises (SMEs), over complying with the bloc's Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism (CBAM), a senior Commerce Department official said.

"CBAM compliances are a concern among SMEs in terms of verification, in terms of finding out what is the value of embedded carbon, in terms of ensuring that the verifiers are recognised by the EU authorities. So there is a comprehensive work plan under the annexure on CBAM, and we are working on it. I am very hopeful that SMEs will not face any problem," Commerce Department Additional Secretary Darpan Jain said at the Indo-German

sumed a significant part of the negotiations, with India pushing for provisions that would mitigate the impact of the EU's new carbon levy on domestic exporters.

MULTIPLE PILLARS
The pact contains a dedicated annexure on CBAM with multiple pillars, he said. One of the provisions requires that if the EU grants any future flexibility under the CBAM regime, the same would be extended to India.

The pact also provides for cooperation on compliance-related issues, including verification of embedded carbon emissions, recognition of verifiers by EU authorities and capacity building for exporters, particularly SMEs, that may lack the technical expertise to comply with the new reporting requirements.

Another important element of the annexure relates to India's evolving domestic carbon pricing framework. "And we also have a provi-

sion in which we can engage with EU authorities on taking into account the carbon price which is paid in India. As you would know, India also is developing its own carbon pricing mechanism. So, how to offset what is paid in India from what is paid in Europe?" he said.

FTA IMPLEMENTATION
On the implementation of the India-EU FTA, Jain said the Commerce Ministry had begun preparations to ensure that businesses across the country are able to fully utilise the agreement once it comes into force.

The Ministry has planned an extensive outreach programme covering more than 700 districts, working with State governments to educate businesses on the opportunities available under the FTA. It is also developing digital tools to help companies, particularly small businesses, understand the agreement and access its benefits more easily, he said.

Govt empanels 16 third-party testing agencies for Coal Exchange

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

The Coal Ministry has empanelled 16 entities as third-party agencies (TPAs) for the collection, preparation, analysis and documentation of coal and lignite samples that will be traded through the Coal Exchange.

In November last, the Ministry floated a request for qualification (RFQ) inviting online applications from eligible agencies.

Coal Exchange is an online platform, where buyers and sellers of coal and its processed forms, transact, trade and enter into contracts.

"The empanelment process has been completed. In response to the RFQ, 16

agencies have been found technically qualified and are hereby empanelled as TPAs for collection, preparation, analysis and documentation of samples of coal and lignite or its processed form that will be transacted through the exchange," the Ministry said.

TIMELINE
The estimated timeline for operationalisation of the regulated coal exchange is 12 months from the date of receipt of an application, for its registration, on the dedicated online application platform opened on July 15.

The empanelled TPAs will perform the assigned activities in accordance with the rules, regulations, guidelines and directions issued by the



CRUCIAL ROLE
TPAs will collect, test and certify coal samples as the Centre prepares to operationalise the regulated Coal Exchange within 12 months

Coal Controller Organisation (CCO), in its capacity as the regulator of the Coal Exchange.

These norms will also be in accordance with the contract executed between the concerned market participants and the TPA under the framework of the Coal Exchange in accordance with the Coal Exchange Rules, 2026, it added.

The TPAs will collect coal samples at the designated sampling points and then prepare laboratory samples from the collected raw samples. These will then be tested and analysed in NABL-accredited laboratories. The agency will prepare test reports and all associated documentation relating to the sampling and testing process.

"Any other activity as may be provided in the contract executed between the concerned market participant (s) and the TPA in the Coal Exchange, in accordance with the guidelines issued by the Coal Controller Organisation (CCO) from time to time," the Ministry said, detailing the responsibilities of the empanelled TPAs.

CCO NORMS
The TPAs will perform the assigned activities in accordance with the rules, regulations, guidelines and directions issued by the CCO, in its capacity as the regulator for the Coal Exchange, from time to time.

"The empanelment shall further be subject to the condition that the empanelled

TPAs shall establish and maintain laboratories equipped with a Laboratory Information Management System (LIMS), a tracking system for providing real-time status updates of samples, and mechanized sampling systems, wherever required by the user agency. They shall upload coal sample results on the designated web portal, in accordance with the terms and conditions of the contract executed under the Coal Exchange and with the approval of the Coal Controller," it said.

The period of empanelment shall be five years from the date of operationalisation of the first Coal Exchange in India under the Coal Exchange Rules, 2026.

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'Petrol would have cost ₹125/litre during March-April without ethanol blending'

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi



Nitin Gadkari, Minister for Road Transport & Highways

Emphasising that ethanol blending helped save almost 32 million tonnes of crude oil, Road & Highways Minister Nitin Gadkari told Parliament on Thursday that petrol would have cost ₹125 per litre during the peak of the West Asia conflict had ethanol blending not been carried out.

The government has been reiterating that the objective behind the ethanol-blended petrol (EBP) programme is to reduce India's almost 88 per cent import dependence on crude oil.

Responding to a starred question in the Lok Sabha, Gadkari said: "During the recent West Asian crisis, despite sharp increases in global crude prices, India was able to shield consumers through calibrated government interventions, diversified

sourcing and the increasing contribution of domestically produced biofuels."

Since February 2026, even though global crude prices rose by around 70-80 per cent, domestic fuel prices increased only by about 7-8 per cent, he emphasised.

"During the peak of West Asia crisis, the market price of petrol could have been around ₹125 per litre, however Indian consumers continued to pay only ₹94.77 per litre (ex-Delhi) also because

OMCs could procure ethanol at around ₹70 per litre," he noted.

By replacing a part of imported petrol with domestically produced ethanol, India reduced its exposure to international crude oil price volatility and exchange-rate fluctuations, he pointed out.

"This demonstrates that ethanol blending is a strategic investment in energy security, price stability, farmer welfare and foreign exchange savings, rather than a revenue-generating exercise for the oil marketing companies," Gadkari stressed.

E20 PETROL PRICE
The retail selling price of E20 petrol is market-determined, and public sector OMCs determine petrol prices after considering international crude oil prices, exchange rates, freight, taxes, ethanol procurement costs and other operational expenses.

For instance, he said during February-March 2026, the retail selling price of petrol remained below the market determined level, resulting in an under-recovery of around ₹21,300 crore for public sector OMCs on account of petrol.

"The EBP has resulted in forex savings of ₹1.98 lakh crore, substitution of nearly 317 lakh tonnes of crude oil, reduction of around 952 lakh tonnes of CO₂ emissions and additional income of over ₹1.66 lakh crore for farmers," Gadkari noted.

Meanwhile, Minister of State for Petroleum & Natural Gas Suresh Gopi emphasised that the government's assessment is based not only on laboratory research but also on large-scale experience after nationwide implementation. Roughly 8 crore vehicles visit fuel retail outlets every day (of this around 80 per cent are petrol vehicles).

EMBASSY REIT

EMBASSY OFFICE PARKS REIT

SEBI Registration No. IN/REIT/17-18/0001

A Real Estate Investment Trust registered with the Securities and Exchange Board of India

Principal Place of Business: 12th Floor, Pinnacle Tower, Embassy One, 8, Bellary Road, Ganganagar, Bengaluru, Karnataka - 560 032. Tel #: +91 80 6935 4864

E-mail: ir@embassyofficeparks.com Website: www.embassyofficeparks.com

Unaudited Financial Results for the quarter ended June 30, 2026

The Board of Directors of Embassy Office Parks Management Services Private Limited, Manager to Embassy Office Parks REIT ("Embassy REIT"), at its meeting held on July 30, 2026 have approved the unaudited standalone and consolidated financial results of Embassy REIT for the quarter ended June 30, 2026 ("Financial Results").

The full format of the Financial Results, including the line items referred to under Regulation 52(4) of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 are available on the websites of BSE Limited at <https://www.bseindia.com/> and National Stock Exchange of India Limited at <https://www.nseindia.com/> and Embassy REIT at <https://www.embassyofficeparks.com/investors/financial-results/> and can also be accessed by scanning the following Quick Response Code:

For and on behalf of the Board of Directors of
Embassy Office Parks Management Services Private Limited
(acting as Manager to Embassy Office Parks REIT)

Sd/-
Jitendra Virwani
Director
DIN: 00027674

Date: July 30, 2026
Place: Dubai

GHCL TEXTILES

GHCL Textiles Limited

Registered Office : GHCL House, Opp. Punjabi Hall, Near Navrangpura Bus Stand, Navrangpura, Ahmedabad - 380 009, Gujarat. Phone : 079-26427519, Email : info@ghcltextiles.co.in, secretarial@ghcltextiles.co.in Website : www.ghcltextiles.co.in, (CIN : L18101GJ2020PLC114004)

EXTRACT OF UNAUDITED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER ENDED JUNE 30, 2026

(₹ in Crores)

S. No.	Particulars	Quarter Ended	Year Ended	Quarter Ended
		30.06.2026	31.03.2026	30.06.2025
		Unaudited	Audited	Unaudited
1	Total Income	409.60	1,334.80	270.07
2	Net Profit before tax	52.79	92.96	18.11
3	Net Profit after tax	39.35	70.37	13.52
4	Total Comprehensive Income (after tax)	39.47	69.89	13.62
5	Paid Up Equity Share Capital (face value of ₹ 2/- each)	19.12	19.12	19.12
6	Other Equity as per the audited balance sheet		1,483.37	
7	Earnings per share (face value of ₹ 2/- each)	(Not Annualised)		(Not Annualised)
	Basic and Diluted (₹)	4.12	7.36	1.41

Note : The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly / Annual Financial Results filed with the stock exchange under regulation 33 of the SEBI (listing obligations and disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Quarterly / Annual Financial Results are available on the website of BSE Limited (URL : www.bseindia.com/corporates), the National Stock Exchange of India Limited (URL : www.nseindia.com/corporates) and on the company's website (URL : <https://ghcltextiles.co.in/investors/financial-reports/>).

Result Link : https://ghcltextiles.co.in/wp-content/uploads/2026/07/GHCLT_integratedresults_30_07_2026.pdf

Noida
July 30, 2026

For and on behalf of Board of Directors of GHCL Textiles Limited
Anurag Dalmia
Chairman

A Dalmia Brothers Enterprise

QUICKLY.

Lohia Corp ends over 16% higher in market debut



New Delhi: Shares of Lohia Corp ended with a premium of over 16 per cent against the issue price of ₹425 on Thursday. The company's shares made market debut at ₹460, up 8.23 per cent from the issue price on the BSE. During the day, the scrip surged 19.64 per cent to ₹508.50. Shares of the firm ended at ₹494.65, up 16.38 per cent. At the NSE, the stock started trading at ₹461, recording a jump of 8.47 per cent. It ended 16.37 per cent higher at ₹494.60. The company's market valuation stood at ₹5,225.98 crore. The IPO of Lohia Corp was subscribed 7.25 times and the ₹1,102 crore IPO had a price band of ₹404-425. The IPO was entirely an offer for sale. ■■

ICICI MF buys nearly 1% stake in Go Digit General

New Delhi: ICICI Prudential Mutual Fund has bought about a 1 per cent stake in Go Digit General Insurance from venture capital firm Peak XV Partners for ₹139 crore, according to block deal data on the NSE. ICICI Prudential Mutual Fund purchased 57,21,378 shares, representing a 0.62 per cent stake of Go Digit General Insurance at an average price of ₹243. Meanwhile, US-based Peak XV, through its affiliate Peak XV Partners Growth Investments III, sold an equal number of shares at the same price. The Competition Commission of India on Tuesday approved the proposed amalgamation of Go Digit Infoworks Services Pvt Ltd with Go Digit General Insurance. ■■

Indo-MIM posts 53% gains on listing day

Our Bureau

Bengaluru

Indo-MIM Ltd made a strong stock market debut on Thursday and ended with 53 per cent listing gains after debuting at a premium of about 44-45 per cent over its initial public offering price after the issue received robust investor demand.

The stock is listed at ₹703 on the BSE, a premium of 44.9 per cent over the IPO price of ₹485 per share. On the NSE, the shares debuted at ₹700, up 44.3 per cent from the issue price. Shares of the precision engineering components maker ended at ₹741.80 on the BSE and at ₹741.75 on the NSE.

Swastika Investmart said the strong listing reflected overwhelming demand from qualified institutional buyers (QIB) and high networth individuals (HNI), as well as the company's position in the metal injection moulding industry.

Shivani Nyati, Head of Wealth at Swastika Investmart, said the stock is trad-

Embassy REIT Q1 net operating income rises 17% to ₹1,020 crore

Press Trust of India

New Delhi

Realty firm Embassy Office Parks REIT on Thursday reported a 17 per cent annual increase in net operating income (NOI) to ₹1,020 crore for the quarter ended June.

Its revenue from operations rose 17 per cent annually to ₹1,241 crore in the first quarter of this fiscal, according to a regulatory filing.

The board of Embassy Office Parks Management Services Pvt Ltd, Manager to Embassy REIT, has declared a distribution of ₹598 crore or ₹6.31 per unit to unitholders for April-June quarter of 2026-27 fiscal.

Amit Shetty, CEO, Embassy REIT, said the company leased 1.3 million sq ft of office space.

Auction to discover closing price from Monday

TEETHING TROUBLE. Brokers may see slight dent in revenues as it could curb high-frequency, liquidity-providing trades towards close

Akshata Gorde

Mumbai

The implementation of the closing auction session (CAS) for stocks in the futures and options (F&O) segment from August 3 is expected to change the way end-of-day trades are executed, with brokers anticipating a modest hit to revenues while the process for determining closing prices becomes more transparent.

Under the new framework, continuous trading in F&O stocks will end at 3.15 pm, followed by a 15-minute auction during which buy and sell orders will be collected and matched at a single equilibrium price that maximises traded volume.

That price will become the stock's official closing price. Non-F&O stocks will continue trading until 3.30 pm, while stock and index deriv-

atives will trade until 3.40 pm.

CLOSING PRICE Currently, the closing price is calculated based on the volume-weighted average price (VWAP) of trades executed during the last 30 minutes of trading.

The changes seek to address two key issues. "Passive funds tracking indices need to execute large orders near the end of the day to match the closing price. These orders can move prices while they are being executed, increasing tracking error," said Zerodha Co-founder Nithin Kamath. "Second, large orders placed in the final few minutes can disproportionately influence the closing prices of stocks and, in turn, the indices they are part of... Since CAS pools all orders and matches them at a single price, influencing the close becomes harder."

A major change from Aug 3

For stocks under F&O	
3.00 pm - 3.15 pm:	Reference price window. The exchange builds a reference price from trades in this 15-minute stretch, much like the old method did.
3.15 pm - 3.20 pm:	The reference price is published. No new orders yet.
3.20 pm - 3.25 pm:	Order entry opens. Both market orders and limit orders are allowed.
3.25 pm - 3.30 pm:	Only limit orders can now be entered, modified or cancelled. Market orders already sitting in the book stay there and still count towards the auction, but they can no longer be modified or cancelled.
3.30 pm - 3.35 pm:	The exchange matches all orders and sets the closing price.
Equity derivatives keep trading until 3.40 pm, giving F&O traders time to adjust to new closing price. Note: There is no change in timing for Non F&O stocks	

He said the transition could probably knock off around 1-5 per cent of brokerage income, while brokers would also have to deal with clients adjusting to different closing times across market segments.

REVENUE IMPACT

Brokers said the move is expected to reduce revenues by curbing high-frequency and

liquidity-providing trades around the close, as the closing auction would replace continuous trading in the final 15 minutes for F&O stocks.

Ajay Garg, Director and CEO of SMC Global Securities, said while institutional orders are expected to migrate to the auction, some execution-driven trading activity that generates

brokerage may see some pressure, resulting in a modest impact on revenues. Delivery-based investing is unlikely to be affected materially, but the shift could slightly alter intra-day trading patterns around the close, he said.

A larger share of institutional and passive fund trades is expected to migrate to the auction session over time.

"The migration is likely to happen gradually rather than all at once. Institutional investors and passive funds are expected to adopt the mechanism faster, while retail participation will build as investors become more familiar with the process," Garg said.

Market participants said the auction mechanism could make it more difficult to influence closing prices through large last-minute trades and improve execu-

tion for index funds and ETFs. Some also expect changes in cash-futures arbitrage strategies, as the final cash market execution price will only be known after the auction.

Deepak Shenoy, Founder of Capitalmind, said the new framework could curb attempts to influence benchmark indices through large closing trades, as seen through large institutional orders in the past. "Now they won't easily be able to with the CAS as their order may not even execute or someone will be able to see it and provide a large enough quantity on the other side to ruin the exercise," he said.

Shenoy, however, said the change could reduce opportunities for high-frequency traders and market jobbers that provide liquidity near the close, while making the overall market structure more robust over time.

Despite hawkish Fed, markets end on a higher note

Our Bureau

Mumbai

Markets closed higher on Thursday, shrugging off a volatile session marked by escalating West Asia tensions, a hawkish undertone from the US Fed and Brent crude inching toward the \$90 mark, a combination that kept investors trading carefully even as domestic earnings provided a floor.

"The Fed's decision to maintain the status quo on rates was largely anticipated, but hawkishness remained due to continued emphasis on inflation control... Renewed crude oil volatility amid West Asian tensions added to external uncertainty," said Vinod Nair, Head of Research, Geojit Investments Ltd.

The Nifty 50 settled at 24,317.15, up 67 points, while the Sensex gained 274 points at 77928.15.

SEBI issues norms to speed up AIF launches

Press Trust of India

New Delhi



Market regulator SEBI on Thursday released an operational framework for a green channel mechanism, GARUDA, to simplify and speed up the launch of schemes by Alternative Investment Funds (AIFs).

The operational framework for the 'Green-Channel: AIF Rollout Upon Document Acknowledgement' (GARUDA) mechanism followed amendments to the SEBI (Alternative Investment Funds) Regulations, 2012, notified earlier this month.

Under the revised framework, AIFs launching regular schemes can proceed with

the launch 10 working days after filing the Placement Memorandum (PPM) with SEBI through a registered merchant banker, unless otherwise advised by the regulator, SEBI said in its circular.

LAUNCH TIMELINE For first-time schemes, launches can commence from the date of SEBI regis-

tration or after the 10-working-day period from filing the application, whichever is later.

The regulator also prescribed a streamlined process for accredited investor-only (AI-only) funds, large value funds (LVFs) and angel funds.

Such funds have been exempted from filing their PPM through a merchant banker and can launch their schemes immediately upon filing the PPM with SEBI.

First schemes of AI-only funds and LVFs can be launched from the date SEBI grants registration, while Angel Funds can circulate their PPMs to investors from the date of registration.

The circular has come into force with immediate effect.

BROKER'S CALL.

JM Financial

HONEYWELL AUTOMATION (BUY)
Target: ₹48,740
CMP: ₹39,581.50
Honeywell Automation India (HWA) sales for Q1-FY27 were in-line, but gross margin strength observed in Q4-FY26 continued at 41 per cent (versus JMFe of 39 per cent). Thus, possibly due to a combination of higher margin order execution and reduced loss order provisioning, EBITDA margin saw about 240 bps y-o-y expansion to 14.3 per cent significantly higher than JMFe of 12.4 per cent. This resulted in 15 per cent beat on EBITDA.

We expect gross margins to remain stable over FY27E-28E at 40-41 per cent leading to 15-16 per cent EBITDA margins. If management's 'razor and razor blade' approach succeeds then EBITDA margin could potentially rise to 18-20 per cent. Furthermore, HWA remains strong on West Asia exports where we anticipate continued strength in capex in oil & gas, renewables, electrolyzers, transmission equipment and data centres. The sharp depreciation of INR versus USD would also aid HWA. Services and exports are higher margin; thus, we do see potential for margin upside.

While HWA has risen 50 per cent YTD FY27, it is trading at 51x/44x FY27/28E EPS, significantly lagging valuation of peers (ABB/SIEM).

HWA trades near lower-end of its long-term (10Y) trading range of 40-60x, largely reflective of the margin weakness seen in the past and, importantly, lack of management communication over the last few years. We maintain Buy with a higher TP of ₹48,740 (earlier ₹44,000) and roll forward to September 2028.

Elara Securities

ORIENT CEMENT (ACCUMULATE)
Target: ₹163
CMP: ₹136
Orient Cement reported Q1FY27 consolidated EBITDA of about ₹140 crore, declining about 21 per cent year on year, ahead of our estimates of about ₹110 crore. Sales volume declined about 21 per cent to about 1.5 million tonne, about 5 per cent below our estimate, marking the company's first double-digit volume decline since September 2024. The sharp decline was primarily driven by its strategic exit from non-remunerative markets, with the management prioritising profitability over market share. Blended realisation fell about 12 per cent at ₹4,027/tonne. Cement realisation after subtracting freight outward improved 9 per cent. Operating cost per tonne declined about 15 per cent to about ₹3,067, driven by lower raw materials consumption and a sharp reduction in other operating expenses. The sharp moderation in operating cost more than offset the impact of weaker realisation

While near-term performance is likely to remain subdued by seasonally-weak demand and soft pricing during the monsoon, we expect volume to recover post monsoon, supported by the Adani Group synergies and its extensive distribution network.

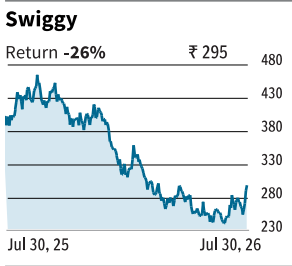
Continued cost optimisation initiatives are set to support margin recovery. In addition, the proposed merger with the parent company, set to be completed in FY27, should provide more flexibility in use of cashflow. We raise our EBITDA estimates by about 1 per cent for FY27 while keeping them unchanged during FY28-29E, due to improvement in cost structure. We reiterate Accumulate with a TP of ₹163.

businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: blmarketwatch@gmail.com

TODAY'S PICK.

Swiggy (₹295.80): BUY

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau



The stock of Swiggy, which has been on a long-term downtrend, started stabilising in May. That is, the downtrend lost momentum and the scrip was largely moving in the sideways band of ₹235-280.

But this week, the stock has gained nearly 18 per cent so far, leading to the breakout of the barrier at ₹280. This is an indication of a bullish trend reversal, at least for the short-term.

Supporting the positive bias, the 21- and 50-day moving averages have seen a bullish crossover.

Therefore, participants can

go long now at ₹295 and buy more shares if the price drops to ₹270. Place stop-loss at ₹232. When the stock rises to ₹330 and ₹360, revise the stop-loss to ₹300 and ₹340, respectively. Book profits at ₹380.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is a risk of loss in trading

Day trading guide

24355 » Nifty 50 Futures					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
24250	24100	24450	24600	Price action suggests a rally; go long with stop-loss at 24225.	
₹756 » HDFC Bank					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
745	730	756	770	Intraday rally expected; go long with a stop-loss at 740.	
₹1156 » Infosys					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1145	1100	1190	1220	Go long as the stock is near support; stop-loss can be 1130.	
₹285 » ITC					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
282	280	290	295	The stock is trading in a range; refrain from fresh positions.	
₹241 » ONGC					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
237	232	244	248	The stock is trading near resistance; sell with stop-loss at 245.	
₹1294 » Reliance Ind.					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1285	1265	1296	1315	Buy the stock if it surpasses 1296; place stop-loss at 1275.	
₹1026 » SBI					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1020	1000	1028	1035	The stock might see an uptick; buy with a stop-loss at 1000.	
₹2431 » TCS					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
2425	2350	2500	2550	The stock could see a rebound; buy with stop-loss at 2380.	
S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.					

Nifty 50 Movers					▲ 66.95 pts.
	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	WN(%)	
Reliance Ind	1292.90	25.09	19.84	7.85	
HDFC Bank	753.95	19.24	14.07	10.37	
M&M	3283.70	12.07	21.93	2.63	
State Bank	1025.30	10.47	10.92	3.81	
Maruti Suzuki	14188.00	6.84	30.39	1.66	
Bharti Airtel	1956.80	4.38	35.25	5.35	
Eicher Motors	7912.50	4.02	39.38	0.98	
Coal India	417.20	3.74	8.27	0.90	
Tech Mahindra	1669.00	3.44	31.68	0.95	
PowerGrid Corp	285.70	2.82	16.68	1.16	
ONGC	241.59	2.78	6.10	0.84	
NestleIndia	1520.70	2.73	76.94	0.98	
Sun Pharma	2001.10	2.59	41.72	1.90	
Hindalco	970.40	2.51	16.28	1.26	
Bajaj Auto	11432.00	2.27	27.66	1.14	
Max Healthcare	1124.80	2.18	75.89	0.75	
Tata Motors PV	334.20	2.01	4102.67	0.63	
HCL Tech	1352.70	1.93	21.06	1.28	
Wipro	186.33	1.70	14.73	0.48	
L&T	3937.70	1.61	27.61	4.14	
Adani Enter	3049.10	1.55	39.86	0.79	
NTPC	344.85	1.40	11.80	1.47	
Apollo Hosp	8989.20	1.31	64.53	0.83	
Dr Reddys Lab	1144.80	0.33	30.02	0.63	
Titan	4850.00	-0.02	84.86	1.80	
TataConsumerProduct	1094.20	-0.27	65.94	0.64	
Infosys	1155.10	-0.38	15.45	3.64	
Trent Ltd.	2999.20	-0.44	92.91	0.90	
Bajaj Finance	1053.50	-0.53	33.93	2.54	
Tata Steel	186.92	-0.63	21.44	1.39	
Grasim Ind	3104.80	-0.68	20.51	1.05	
Cipla	1466.40	-0.97	35.30	0.74	
JSW Steel	1270.80	-1.19	11.10	1.07	
Asian Paints	2746.20	-1.21	59.94	1.12	
Kotak Bank	389.40	-1.29	19.08	2.58	
SBI Life	1877.50	-1.71	72.42	0.76	
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	246.95	-1.81	78.91	0.73	
Eternal Ltd.	310.65	-1.82	69.23	2.02	
Bajaj Finserv	1909.40	-1.90	15.54	0.99	
Hind Unilever	2107.90	-1.92	47.20	1.68	
Bharat Elec	384.90	-2.07	45.77	1.24	
Int'lGlobeAvi	5229.90	-2.27	0.00	1.06	
ITC	285.05	-2.53	16.99	2.47	
HDFC Life	545.40	-2.66	59.59	0.53	
TCS	2431.80	-3.30	17.58	2.23	
UltraTech Cement	11847.00	-3.90	40.73	1.26	
Axis Bank	1228.90	-4.08	13.68	3.17	
Shriram Finance Ltd.	1027.20	-5.35	21.35	1.29	
ICICI Bank	1453.90	-6.26	17.21	9.23	
Adani Ports	1664.10	-8.96	30.00	1.10	
Pts: Impact on index movement					

Nifty Next 50 Movers					▲ 72.40 pts.
	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	WN(%)	
Tvs Motor Cmp	425.40	90.66	55.52	3.95	
Indian Hotels Co.	749.25	28.20	14.07	2.63	
United Spirits .	1531.90	23.61	66.05	1.81	
Tata Motors Cv	414.95	21.55	50.46	3.46	
Divis Lab	7835.00	18.65	80.99	3.98	
Varun Beverages .	451.35	16.49	44.78	2.47	
Vedanta	267.50	14.78	6.60	1.81	
Bosch	41550.00	12.23	44.19	1.44	
Avenuesuper	3874.00	12.13	82.64	2.50	
Hyundai Motor India .	2018.20	10.48	30.19	1.15	
SamvardhanaInternatnl	146.72	9.24	37.90	2.59	
Cg Power & Ind Sol	832.60	6.18	105.91	2.28	
Punjab Natl Bank	111.64	5.60	5.80	1.54	
Jindal Steel	1093.70	5.38	41.19	1.62	
Cummins India	5396.00	5.10	63.33	2.91	
LtImidtree	4441.40	5.05	25.35	1.65	
Bajaj Holdings	10970.00	2.64	12.47	1.07	
Hdfc Amc	2546.30	2.61	37.03	2.08	
Mazagon Dock	2319.10	2.49	33.95	0.70	
Britannia Ind	5524.50	2.40	52.45	2.60	
Rural Elec	374.90	2.36	6.16	1.87	
Siemens	3658.80	2.06	85.01	1.29	
Pidlittind	1623.90	0.80	67.14	2.02	
Hindus Zinc	535.90	-1.12	13.27	1.03	
Indian Railway Finance Corp	88.92	-1.23	16.58	0.71	
Tata Capital	360.90	-1.32	27.97	0.73	
Indian Oilcorp	139.94	-1.85	4.52	2.09	
Solar Industries	18053.00	-1.91	94.07	1.76	
Adani Cement	434.20	-1.99	20.80	1.08	
Torront Pharm	4872.10	-2.73	86.68	2.86	
Murthofin	3008.70	-2.87	11.39	1.29	
Abb India	7291.50	-2.90	97.78	1.53	
Power Finance	426.25	-3.60	4.18	2.48	
Union Bank	170.40	-3.82	6.30	1.32	
Canara Bank	124.28	-4.30	5.69	1.67	
Godrej Consumer	1072.10	-5.14	58.93	1.72	
ZydusIntelliences	1115.10	-5.53	21.90	1.12	
Hindustaneronautics	4581.40	-5.84	33.61	3.47	
Tata Power	375.95	-6.30	22.86	2.51	
Adani Power .	208.97	-6.63	27.73	3.47	
Energy Solutions .	1659.80	-8.40	64.49	1.18	
Bank Of Baroda	241.65	-9.17	6.79	1.79	
Bpci	313.80	-9.42	8.00	2.56	
Bank of India	111.64	-11.60	15.06	1.67	
Siemens Energy India	3121.70	-12.59	84.88	1.10	
AdaniGreenenergy	1358.70	-14.03	104.29	1.82	
Shree Cement	2645.00	-14.38	54.59	1.41	
Macrof Development .	1287.15	-23.54	31.15	1.43	
DCIT	674.85	-28.71	36.72	1.68	
Cholamandalam&Fin	1773.80	-36.59	28.29	3.07	
Pts: Impact on index movement					

A QUOI SERT

QUICKLY.

Gold rises on weaker \$, soft inflation data



Gold rose on Thursday as the US dollar weakened and inflation eased in line with expectations, with traders dialling back bets on interest rate hikes. Spot gold was up 1.1 per cent to \$4,109.94 per ounce by 1403 GMT. US gold futures for August delivery gained 1.9 per cent to \$4,108.30. Silver rose 1.5 per cent to \$58.52. REUTERS

Thinning inventories, weaker dollar lift copper

London: Copper moved higher supported a weaker dollar, after the Federal Reserve said it would keep interest rates steady, and tight inventories outside the US. Benchmark three month copper on the LME was up 1.2 per cent to \$13,747.50 a tonne as of 0932 GMT. LME copper stocks fell by 6,900 tonnes to 255,400 tonnes, the lowest since February. REUTERS

Palm oil gains for second session on firmer crude oil



Kuala Lumpur: Malaysian palm oil futures reversed earlier losses to edge higher for a second straight session, buoyed by stronger crude oil prices and firmer Dalian palmolein and Chicago soyoil. The benchmark palm oil contract for October delivery on the BMD Exchange gained 15 ringgit to 4,679 ringgit (\$1,144.29) a tonne. REUTERS

Q2 gold jewellery demand falls 15% as volatile prices put off consumers

STILL SOUGHT AFTER. However, demand for yellow metal is still high in value terms, says Sachin Jain of WGC

Suresh P Iyengar
Mumbai

With jewellery demand dropping to the second lowest in the second quarter since 2000, India's gold demand in the June quarter declined by 6 per cent to 131 tonnes. This was because volatile prices forced consumers to postpone their jewellery purchases. Jewellery demand plunged 15 per cent to 75 tonnes against 89 tonnes. Notwithstanding the strong sales during *Akshaya Tritiya*, the second quarter demand dropped. Demand weakened from mid-quarter due to the month-long inauspicious period (mid-May to mid-June) and levy of 9 per cent import duty hike. However, in value terms, jewellery demand jumped 34 per cent to ₹1.13 lakh crore (₹84,200 crore).

Overall gold demand in terms of value was up 50 per cent to ₹1.98 lakh crore against ₹1.32 lakh crore logged in the same period last year, according to the Gold Demand Trend report released by the World Gold Council (WGC) on Thursday.

ETF DEMAND UP 62% On the other hand, demand for investment increased. Demand for gold bars and coins increased 9 per cent to 50 tonnes (46 tonnes). In value terms, it was worth ₹75,700 crore (₹43,700 crore). Exchange traded funds rose 62 per cent y-o-y in the June quarter to 4 tonnes (2 tonnes) even as it was down 82 per cent sequentially compared to 20 tonnes in the March quarter. Sachin Jain, Regional CEO-India, World Gold Council, said while demand had fallen in terms of ton-



BULL RUN INTACT. Despite the recent pullback, gold prices are up 59 per cent year-on-year, trading at ₹1.51 lakh per 10 g against ₹94,877 a year ago

nage, it is still higher in value terms, which actually means consumers are buying gold as per their budget with prices falling from highs seen in the last few months.

Moreover, he said Prime Minister Narendra Modi's call to cut down on gold purchases had its impact on softening demand. Despite the recent fall,

gold prices are still higher by 59 per cent at ₹1.51 lakh per 10 g against ₹94,877 logged in the same period last year, he said.

STORE EXPANSIONS The steady store expansion amid falling demand led to an increase in inventory levels at jewellers' end. It touched a high of 21 tonnes

M.P. suspends e-token system for fertilizer

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

The Madhya Pradesh government has agreed to suspend the e-token system for fertilizer distribution and has assured the farmers to procure 60 per cent (from the current 25 per cent) of the moong crop.

After this, agitating farmers called off their protest in Bhopal.

However, the protest highlighted policy gaps and the risk of agricultural reforms in the farm sector, experts said.

Reacting to a letter from State Agriculture Minister

Aidal Singh Kansana, Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan on July 29 wrote to Chief Minister Mohan Yadav, pointing out that the Centre had already approved the procurement of up to 4.55 lakh tonnes (lt) of summer moong for Madhya Pradesh under the Price Support Scheme, accounting for 87 per cent of the quantity approved nationally under the PM-AASHA scheme whereas the State had bought only 60,000 tonnes.

Chouhan said that under the PM-AASHA scheme guidelines, only 25 per cent of production is permitted to be procured under the MSP whereas any quantity above

The State has told farmers it will procure 60% (from the current 25%) of the moong crop

it will be the sole responsibility of the State.

APPROVED AGENCIES A former State Agriculture Secretary said the gaps have to be corrected if required, and the States cannot be blamed every time.

Under the PM-AASHA scheme, the Centre has decided who should be the "central nodal agencies" to procure the crop, and the

agencies are solely responsible for it. "Let the Centre nominate State agencies independently and hold them accountable for any delay or non-procurement," the former official suggested.

Under the PM-AASHA scheme, which facilitates the buying of oilseeds and pulses from farmers at minimum support prices (MSPs), Nafed and NCCF are the agencies approved for procurement.

Due to high level of moong production in the summer (*zaid*) season, Madhya Pradesh is the largest producer in the country, having over 40 per cent share.

In 2025-26, out of 44.92 lt

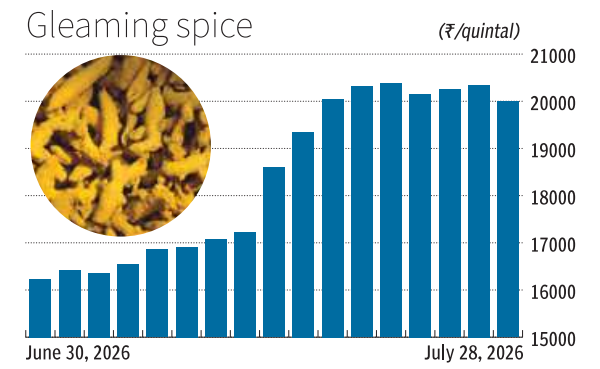
moong produced in the country, 18.39 lt (including 18.18 lt in the summer season) was produced in Madhya Pradesh.

If the State is able to procure 60 per cent of summer moong, it may have to buy nearly 11 lt.

On the decision to suspend the e-token system for distribution of subsidised fertilizers, primarily urea and DAP, industry leaders are divided.

While a manufacturer of micronutrients supported the move, a top official of a leading fertilizer company welcomed the suspension and said "it was supposed to be stopped."

Turmeric prices soar on tight supplies, fear over deficient monsoon rain



Source: NCDEX

Subramani Ra Namcombu
Chennai

Turmeric prices in the country have surged to record highs on a hand-to-mouth supply situation and fears of El Nino impact on the crop that is currently being sown, said industry stakeholders.

"Turmeric prices surged to ₹210 a kg in Tamil Nadu's Erode market from ₹160 a kg in 10 days in the futures market. Deficient monsoon rain in June aided the bullishness," said Ankit Agarwal, Director at the Erode-based Amar Agarwal Foods India Ltd.

"Though speculation contributed a bit to the rise, prices were up due to deficient rain and fear of the next crop being affected. The carry forward stocks we had in the past 3-4 years have declined," said RKV Ravishankar, President of the Erode Turmeric Merchants Association.

On Tuesday, turmeric August contract was quoted at ₹20,518 a quintal. Nizamabad spot prices ruled at ₹19,989, while Rajapur prices were ₹22,070, according to the NCDEX. Turmeric prices remain supported as persistent dry weather has raised concerns about the crop prospects.

Continued dry conditions during the early growth and development stages could adversely affect yields,

thereby further supporting prices, said Biplab Sarma, Senior Research Analyst (Team Leader) at Agri-Watch.

"Besides deficient rainfall, there is a shortage of quality material," said Nizamabad-based trade expert Poonam Chand Gupta. Fears over the crop are despite a rise in the area. "Sowing is up 10 per cent compared to last year," he said.

EXPORTS UP Sarma said AgriWatch's kharif 2026 first advance estimate projected turmeric acreage increasing by 16.05 per cent year-on-year from 2025 and remaining well above the 5-year average of 1.88 lakh hectares. "This is primarily due to higher prices farmers got during the sowing period," he said.

Agarwal said this year production was 95 lakh bags of 50 kg each. "If export demand is added, we will require 110 lakh bags. There is a carry-over of 15-20 lakh bags, which will leave supplies tight in the coming months if El Nino leads to deficient rain," he said.

Ravishankar said demand is currently slow, which led prices to pull back. "Demand will begin from August-end," he said.

Agarwal said though prices may retract a bit, they will not return to ₹140-150 a kg levels until the next crop.

Domestic sugar prices to remain firm in short-term, says Triveni

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Higher sales volume and better price realisation in sugar helped Triveni Engineering & Industries, a leading integrated sugar and ethanol manufacturer, to register 2.1 per cent growth in net turnover (net of excise duty) at ₹1,581 crore for Q1 FY27 (April-June).

This was despite the lower offtake in alcohol and a dip in revenue from the wastewater business.

"Profitability improvement in Q1 FY27 is primarily attributable to increase in sugar margin led by higher realisation and lower procurement costs of maize, improved by-product (DDGS) realisation and other production/operational efficiencies in the alcohol segment," the company said in a statement.

During Q1 FY27, the com-

pany sold 2,77,403 tonnes of sugar, up by 7.4 per cent from 2,58,196 tonnes a year ago, with an average realisation of ₹41,525/tonne against ₹40,421/tonne.

The company said domestic sugar prices remained firm throughout FY26 due to lower than expected production and further supported by exports.

EL NINO IMPACT Attributing 0.7 million tonnes (mt) of export and 3 mt of diversion towards ethanol during the current sugar season (October 2025-September 2026), it said these had impacted the country's sugar stock, which may reach a 10-year low of 4.1 mt as on September 30, 2026, the lowest since September 2017.

Dhruv M Sawhney, Chairman and Managing Director, said that sugar prices subsequent to the quarter had significantly firmed up in

line with the estimates of lower inventories at the end of the 2025-26 season as well as due to uncertainties about the impact of El Nino on production next season.

ETHANOL POLICY The present position of capacities outstripping demand needs to be rectified to exploit the full potential of ethanol, Sawhney said.

"We look forward to new policy initiatives under the 'Beyond E-20' framework, including the adoption of flex-fuel vehicles and new applications for ethanol as these have the potential to strengthen long-term demand for biofuels and create additional growth avenues for the industry."

The company's sugar inventory as on June 30 was lower at 0.36 mt against 0.45 mt year-ago. On the other hand, the realised sugar price was ₹38.41/kg against ₹37.41/kg.

Go long on August zinc futures at ₹379

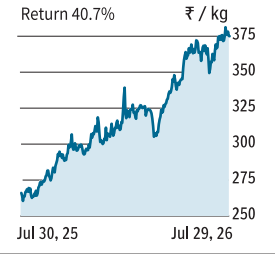
Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Zinc futures have been in a long-term uptrend. The July contract is now at ₹384/kg whereas the August series is at ₹379. Since the July contract expires on Friday (July 31), we shall pick August futures for analysis.

COMMODITY CALL.

The August zinc futures broke out of a resistance at ₹376 last week. But since then, the contract has largely been moving sideways between ₹375 and ₹381. As long as it trades above ₹370, the near-term outlook will be bullish. So, we expect zinc futures (August) to surpass ₹381 soon and rally to ₹400.

However, if the contract declines from the current level and breaches the support at ₹370, the near-term outlook can turn weak. This



could potentially lead to a fall to ₹355. Support below ₹355 is at ₹348.

TRADE STRATEGY Last week, we had suggested buying the July futures at ₹382 with a stop-loss at ₹370. Since it expires on Friday and the outlook on zinc futures is positive, traders can roll over the longs to August futures.

That is, exit the July contract now at ₹384 and go long on August futures at ₹379. Place stop-loss at ₹366. When the contract rises to ₹390, revise the stop-loss to ₹3832. Book profits at ₹400.

Buffalo meat, non-basmati rice lift Q1 agri produce exports to \$7.641 billion

Vishwanath Kulkarni
Bengaluru

Robust demand for buffalo meat and non-basmati rice pushed up India's exports of agricultural products, which are monitored by Apeda, by around 14 per cent in value terms to \$7.641 billion during the April-June quarter of the current financial year.

Exports stood at \$6.711 billion in the same period last year. Non-basmati rice exports grew around 12 per cent to \$1.59 billion during the first quarter over \$1.41 billion in the previous year.

In volume terms, the non-basmati rice shipments registered 32 per cent growth at 4.38 million tonnes (3.32 million tonnes in Q1 last



year). Buffalo meat (carabeef) shipments saw a 66 per cent increase to \$1.49 billion (896.82 million in Q1 last year). In volume terms, buffalo meat exports were up 32 per cent at 3.4 lakh tonnes over the corresponding previous year's 2.57 lakh tonnes.

Basmati rice shipments declined 3 per cent in value at \$1.44 billion (\$1.49 billion) on reduced volumes.

Shipment volumes of basmati rice were down at 15.39 lakh tonnes against 17.32

Robust trend			
Agri product exports (in \$ million)			
	April-June		
	FY27	FY26	
Non-basmati Rice	1,590	1,413	
Buffalo meat	1,493	896	
Basmati	1,442	1,494	
Total	7,641	6,711	

Source: Apeda

lakh tonnes the previous year.

PULSES UP 52% Exports of miscellaneous processed items were up around 14 per cent at \$470.7 million (413 million), while pulses registered a growth of 52 per cent during the quarter at \$363.77 million (\$238.75 million). In volume terms, the exports of pulses stood at over 4.02 lakh

tonnes during the quarter against the corresponding last year's 2.39 lakh tonnes.

OTHER ITEMS Shipments of processed vegetables were marginally up at \$207.61 million (\$204.69 million), while fresh vegetable exports were down at \$175.46 million (\$197.57 million). Other products that witnessed a decline in exports include fresh fruits at \$281.11 million (\$324.87 million), dairy products at \$171.27 million (\$182.22 million), groundnut at \$164.19 million (\$180.27 million) and guar gum at \$149.53 million (\$166.15 million).

Poultry products also witnessed a decline at \$53.73 million (\$73.26 million).

Crude oil down in choppy trade amid geopolitical tensions

Reuters

Crude oil prices were volatile as investors weighed talks between Oman and Iran over the Strait of Hormuz and escalating tensions between the US and Iran.

Brent futures were down 36 cents at \$90.38 a barrel as of 1111 GMT after touching a high of \$93.31. US West Texas Intermediate crude futures were down 72 cents at \$83.74, after hitting a high of \$85.94.

The Strait of Hormuz, which normally handles around a fifth of global oil and liquefied natural gas flows, has remained a focal point for oil markets since the Iran war began on February 28.

El Nino likely to strengthen further during Oct-Dec: Govt

Our Bureau
Mangaluru

The government has said that El Nino is likely to further strengthen during the October-December period, and may reach a very strong category.

In a written reply in the Rajya Sabha on Thursday, Jitendra Singh, Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) for Science and Technology and Earth Sciences, said El Nino events are generally classified as weak, moderate, strong or very strong based on the magnitude of sea surface temperature anomalies over the equatorial central Pacific Ocean.

The India Meteorological

Department (IMD) has predicted the development of El Nino conditions during the 2026 South-West monsoon season. El Nino conditions were weak during June 2026 and intensified to moderate levels in July 2026.

DETERMINING FACTORS "El Nino is likely to strengthen further during the October-December 2026 season and may reach a very strong category. However, its exact intensity and impact over the Indian region depend on the evolution of coupled ocean-atmosphere conditions, of which El Nino is one factor," he said, adding that the IMD continuously monitors the evolution of oceanic and atmospheric conditions and issues regular

seasonal and monthly forecasts and advisories.

IMD, under the Ministry, continuously monitors the evolution of El Nino and other climate drivers and issues regular seasonal/monthly forecasts, extended-range forecasts and weather advisories to the Central and State governments and other stakeholders.

IMD issues impact-based forecasts and risk-based warnings daily, valid for the next seven days through multiple communication channels for use by disaster management authorities, State governments, district administrations, and other stakeholders to support preparedness and response measures, he said.

QUICKLY.

Natural gas’ supply share stood at 7.12% in FY25

New Delhi: The share of natural gas in India’s primary energy supply has risen, albeit marginally, to 7.12 per cent on a provisional basis in FY25, as per Energy Statistics 2026 released by the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation, Minister of State for Petroleum & Natural Gas Suresh Gopi said in a written response in the Lok Sabha. The share of natural gas was 7 per cent in FY24 and it was 6.7 per cent in FY23. The demand is projected to grow to 260-300 million standard cubic meters per day by 2030 under the base case scenario, he said.

GSTN postpones e-way bill enhancements

New Delhi: The GST Network has put on hold two proposed e-way bill enhancements after hearing industry feedback. They were proposed to be implemented from August 1. The first was the mandatory capture of the ‘Ship-To GSTIN’ in Bill-to-Ship-to transactions. The second enhancement was the introduction of a ‘voluntary closure’ facility, which would have enabled taxpayers to close an active e-Way Bill in specified situations where the goods movement did not ultimately take place.

PM E-Drive yet to fuel e-bus adoption, charging infra lags

GROWTH GAP. 14,000 e-buses allocated, but concessions signed for 1,515 only: MHI data

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

The flagship PM E-Drive scheme has significantly accelerated electric vehicle adoption, supporting more than 23 lakh electric two- and three-wheelers and helping EV penetration rise from 0.7 per cent in FY20 to 8.2 per cent in FY26. However, the progress update from the Ministry of Heavy Industries reveals slower implementation across key supporting infrastructure, including electric buses, charging networks and battery manufacturing.

Data released by the Ministry on Tuesday showed that 23.23 lakh electric two- and three-wheelers received incentives between April 1, 2024, and July 22, 2026, with manufacturers reimbursed ₹2,281.94 crore. Of this, electric two-wheelers accounted for 20.57 lakh vehicles and ₹1,505.3 crore in incentives, while 2.61 lakh L5 (high speed, heavy duty) electric three-wheelers received ₹769.02 crore. An additional ₹7.61 crore was disbursed for 5,082 e-rickshaws and e-



SLOW ROLLOUT. Of the ₹2,000 crore earmarked for charging facilities, ₹689 crore was approved for deploying 6,562 chargers

carts. The two-wheeler segment has achieved around 83 per cent of its target of 24.79 lakh vehicles under the scheme, making it the strongest-performing component of PM E-Drive. Incentives for electric two-wheelers are set to end on July 31, 2026, although the government is considering an extension. Any continuation would require fresh budgetary support, as the scheme’s ₹10,900 crore allocation has already been committed.

SLOW DEALS While vehicle adoption has increased, progress in electric bus deployment remains limited. Letters of confirma-

tion of demand and quantity have been issued for 13,800 e-buses across Delhi, Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Mumbai, Ahmedabad, Pune and Surat. An additional 200 buses have been sanctioned for Jammu & Kashmir, taking total allocations to 14,000 against a target of 14,028. However, concession agreements have been signed for only 1,515 buses so far, comprising 915 in Hyderabad and 600 in Surat. That represents just about 11 per cent of the buses allocated to the seven major cities, highlighting the gap between allocations and actual deployment. Successful bidders must still secure prototype approvals before buses can be

rolled out. The bus and truck segment is also facing supply-chain challenges, with manufacturers seeking relaxation of localisation norms due to difficulties in sourcing heavy rare-earth magnets used in traction motors. Progress in charging infra remains in its early stages. Of the ₹2,000 crore earmarked for public charging facilities, ₹689 crore had been approved by July 1 for deploying 6,562 chargers through three oil marketing companies and nine State governments. As of March 24, no funds had been disbursed for charging infra under the scheme. The government is also attempting to build domestic battery manufacturing capacity. On July 29, the Ministry held a pre-bid meeting for the final 10 GWh of capacity under the ₹18,100-crore Advanced Chemistry Cell PLI scheme, attracting 29 prospective bidders. Yet, implementation remains slow. While 40 GWh of the scheme’s 50 GWh target has already been awarded, official data show only 1 GWh of installed capacity; also, no beneficiary had claimed incentives as of February 2026.

Chennai remains Casagrand’s backbone as developer eyes next phase of growth

Our Bureau
Chennai



(From left) LV Navaneeth, CEO, The Hindu Group; B Rajkumar, TN Minister for Housing and Urban Development and Arun MN, Managing Director, Casagrand at the event in Chennai BUOY GHOSH

Even as Casagrand expands across India and overseas, Chennai will continue to be the company’s backbone, founder and managing director MN Arun said on Thursday, underscoring the city’s central role in the real estate developer’s growth strategy. Speaking at The Hindu Real Estate & Urban Infrastructure Summit 2026, Arun stated that Casagrand’s ambition to scale from over ₹10,000 crore in annual sales to ₹25,000 crore and beyond would be built on the same principles that have shaped the company since its inception in Chennai in 2003. “Chennai is a great support system for us. It is the backbone for all of us,” he said during a fireside chat with The Hindu CEO, LV Navaneeth. While expansion into cities such as Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Pune, Delhi, and Mumbai is necessary for growth, the company’s foundation remains firmly rooted in the Tamil Nadu capital, he added. Arun said high-rise developments and integrated townships would increasingly shape Chennai’s urban future as the city accommodates a growing population. Large

residential communities, he noted, offer opportunities for social interaction through parks, open spaces, clubhouses and community events, helping residents build stronger neighbourhood connections. He said homebuyers in Chennai have evolved significantly over the past decade and are now far more informed and value-conscious. Buyers today evaluate projects not only on location and pricing but also on amenities, specifications, maintenance costs, resale prospects and overall quality of life. Arun also stressed that infrastructure creation should be a shared responsibility between governments and private developers. He said Casagrand has invested in roads, water treatment facilities, sewage systems and other civic infrastructure

within several of its large projects, particularly in suburban areas where public infrastructure is still developing. **URBAN VISION** Addressing the summit, Tamil Nadu Housing and Urban Development Minister B Rajkumar said a State’s progress cannot be measured by buildings alone. Sustainable growth, he said, depends on factors such as water availability, roads, public transport and overall public welfare. Tamil Nadu is among the country’s fastest-growing economies, driven by strong manufacturing growth and rising investments, which in turn boost demand for housing, industrial parks and urban infrastructure, he said. “Real estate is an important sector. If it grows, the State’s economy grows,” the Minister said.

TN moves SC on HC ‘no’ to government jobs for Karur stampede victims’ next of kin

Krishnadas Rajagopal
New Delhi

The Tamil Nadu government has moved the Supreme Court in an appeal against a Madras High Court decision to strike down the grant of government jobs to the family members of Karur stampede victims. The Madurai Bench of the High Court had quashed the government orders on July 27. The State had argued in the court that the appointments were meant as a humane gesture. But the court concluded that specific guidelines covered the field of compassionate appointments, and they cannot be cast aside by the State government. The High Court had warned that the government’s action, if condoned, may run the risk of opening the floodgates.

EXISTING WAIT LIST The High Court had pointed out that there were waitlists in every government department for appointments on compassionate grounds. Employment

has to be granted only in accordance with seniority and not with reference to the immediate nature of relief to be granted, the Division Bench of the High Court had noted. The High Court had reasoned that it would be in violation of the fundamental rights of equality and due process of law, enshrined in Article 14 and 21 of the Constitution, respectively, to overlook those in the waiting list in a bid to bring relief to the family members of the Karur stampede victims. The State had contended that these jobs were given in exercise of its executive powers under Article 162 of the Constitution. But the High Court had responded that any exercise of executive authority or power had to be within the confines of the Constitution. The stampede occurred in September last year during a Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK) roadshow as part of a poll campaign addressed by the party founder and president C Joseph Vijay, the current chief minister.

Tamil Nadu signs investment MoUs in GCC, advanced manufacturing

Our Bureau
Chennai



The agreements were signed between Guidance Tamil Nadu and the companies in the presence of Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay

Tamil Nadu signed Memoranda of Understanding (MoUs) with four global institutions spanning investments in global capability centres (GCCs), research and development, advanced manufacturing, and higher education. The projects are expected to generate more than 2,920 direct and indirect jobs. **JOBS BOOST** The agreements were signed on Thursday between Guidance Tamil Nadu and the companies in the presence of Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay. Among the announcements, Swiss insurance major Chubb and German wind turbine manufacturer Nordex will establish their first Global Capability Centres (GCCs) and research and development (R&D) centres in Tamil Nadu.

The facilities, which will be located in Chennai, are expected to create 1,220 high-skilled jobs, with Chubb generating around 220 jobs and Nordex about 1,000. **ACADEMIC LANDMARK** In a significant development for the State’s higher education sector, the University of Western Australia (UWA) will establish its India campus in Chennai under the UGC (Setting up and Operation of Campuses of Foreign Higher Educational Institutions in India) Regulations, 2023.

According to the government, the campus will be the first international university campus to be established in Tamil Nadu. **KOREAN INVESTMENT** The State also secured a ₹300-crore investment from South Korean auto-component manufacturer MotiveLink, which will set up a factory at the Sipcot Industrial Park in Pil-laipakkam, Kancheepuram district. The project is expected to create around 1,500 jobs. The investment follows Industries Minister Keerthana’s visit to South Korea

in June 2026 as part of Tamil Nadu’s overseas investment outreach. **STRATEGIC WIN** Industry sources said Andhra Pradesh had also been competing for the project, with Andhra Pradesh Minister Nara Lokesh also meeting representatives of MotiveLink during his visit to South Korea. “This investment strengthens the State’s electric vehicle ecosystem, creates quality jobs for youth and reaffirms the confidence that global companies have in Tamil Nadu’s future,” Industries Minister Keerthana said. The latest round of investments reinforces Tamil Nadu’s strategy of attracting high-value investments across knowledge-intensive sectors such as GCCs and R&D, while simultaneously expanding its manufacturing base and positioning Chennai as a destination for international higher education.

State govt forms expert committee to advise on mitigating El Nino impact

Ouri Bureau
Chennai

The Tamil Nadu government has constituted an expert committee to advise the Tamil Nadu Disaster Risk Reduction Agency (TNDRA) on the steps to be taken to address the challenges posed by the strong El Nino. The Committee will comprise academicians and researchers from institutes like IIT-Madras, Anna University and Suganthi Devadason Marine Research In-

stitute (SMRI), Tamil Nadu Marine Research Foundation (TNMRF) as well as other related agencies, including Tamil Nadu Green Climate Company (TNGCC), WRI India, Tamil Nadu Marine Research Foundation (TNMRF), and officials from State government agencies. In an official statement the State government said that there is a high probability of a severe El Nino effect developing in 2026. Consequently, the South-west Monsoon rainfall could be below normal, potentially

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All other terms and conditions will remain unchanged.	
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QUICKLY.

Mahindra Last Mile
Mobility to raise ₹322 cr

Mumbai: Mahindra Last Mile Mobility (MLMML) has signed a binding agreement to raise approximately ₹322 crore in a fresh funding round led by Lightrock, with participation from existing investors IFC and the Indo-Japan Fund (managed by NIIF). The investment values the business at ₹1,082.2 crore, more than doubling its previous valuation. MLMML has recorded a 6X growth in electric three-wheeler sales over the last four years, remains the market leader in the L5 electric three-wheeler segment with a 40 per cent market share. **OUR BUREAU**

Sun Pharma's semaglutide
gets nod from Brazil



Mumbai: Sun Pharmaceutical Industries has received approval from the Brazilian Health Regulatory Agency — ANVISA — to manufacture and market semaglutide injection in Brazil for treating adults with inadequately controlled type 2 diabetes mellitus, the drugmaker said. Sun Pharma plans to launch the product in the next few days in partnership with Hypera Pharma, a pharmaceutical company in Brazil. It will be available as amulti-dose injectable pen in two strengths (2 mg/1.5 mL and 4 mg/3 mL). **OUR BUREAU**

Quality reforms crucial to keep India as ‘pharmacy of world’: Manoj Joshi

SHARP FOCUS. Reducing dependence on imported APIs remains one of the long-term challenges

bl.interview

Ankita Upadhyay
New Delhi

From implementation of revised Schedule M norms to tighter regulatory oversight and efforts to improve manufacturing, Manoj Joshi, Secretary, Department of Pharmaceuticals, covered the government’s roadmap to strengthen India’s pharmaceutical sector amid concerns over drug quality, export scrutiny and rising medicine costs. Joshi highlighted the industry’s long-term challenges, including building a robust biopharma ecosystem, reducing dependence on imported APIs and enhancing quality surveillance.

Edited excerpts:

Following concerns over substandard medicines and scrutiny of Indian drug exports, what reforms has the government undertaken to strengthen manufacturing quality and regulatory oversight?
The revised Schedule M became mandatory from January 1. Companies that do not comply with the revised WHO-GMP standards are being asked to shut down unless they are in the process of upgrading.

Other measures include



The first priority is building a strong ecosystem for biological drugs, including better regulation, start-ups and drug discovery

MANOJ JOSHI
Secretary, Department of Pharmaceuticals



stricter regulation of exports, requiring regulatory no objection certificates (NOCs) for certain products not sold domestically. Revised Schedule M also prevents non-compliant companies from participating in government tenders.

Looking ahead, what do you see as the three biggest challenges for the Indian pharmaceutical industry over the next decade, and what policy interventions will be critical to ensure India remains the ‘pharmacy of the world’?
The first priority is building a strong ecosystem for biological drugs, including better regulation, start-ups and drug discovery. The second is reducing dependence on imported bulk drugs by strengthening the domestic value chain.

The third is improving

drug quality through stronger surveillance and regulatory action, particularly by state regulators.

There have been repeated concerns about rising prices of medicines outside the National List of Essential Medicines. Is the government considering expanding price controls or introducing trade margin rationalisation for more drugs?

Prices of essential drugs are already regulated, and companies cannot increase prices by more than 10 per cent in a year. As for trade margin rationalisation, the issue is under consideration. There are concerns about exorbitant trade margins, especially on expensive medicines, which can encourage malpractices.

The challenge is to find a balanced approach because

limiting margins by percentage may create problems for cheaper drugs, particularly in rural areas where higher margins may be necessary.

What are the government’s thoughts on requests from the industry for price increases due to rising costs caused by war, packaging and insurance?

The government has asked the industry to provide detailed data on cost increases. The National Pharmaceutical Pricing Authority is examining requests supported by evidence, particularly where there have been significant increases in API prices. However, many companies have only made general requests without submitting adequate data.

The pharmaceutical industry argues that stricter price controls discourage investments in research and innovation. How is the government balancing affordable medicines with encouraging innovation?

These are separate issues. Around 80 per cent of medicines are already outside price control. The problem is that Indian companies generally do not invest enough in R&D.

According to industry, investors and stock markets treat R&D spending as an ex-

pense rather than an investment, discouraging companies from investing more in innovation.

India still depends heavily on imports of APIs. Has the production-linked incentive scheme reduced this dependence, and what are the next priorities?

About 30-35 per cent of drugs still depend on imports from China, while 60-65 per cent have an entirely domestic value chain. Under the PLI scheme, production of key bulk drugs such as Penicillin G and clavulanic acid has started in India. The government intends to encourage more companies through incentives and protective measures so that domestic manufacturing expands further.

What are the government’s targets for pharmaceutical exports over the next five years, and which markets offer the biggest opportunities?

The government does not set export targets for the industry. The US remains the largest and most profitable pharmaceutical market, followed by Europe and Japan. Other important markets include Latin America, Africa and East Asia. Companies decide their own market strategies depending on their products.

Maharashtra’s FDA chief Mundhe on clean-up drive

Aneesh Phadnis
Mumbai



Tukaram Mundhe, FDA Commissioner, Maharashtra

In his two-month tenure in the state Food and Drug Administration (FDA) department, Tukaram Mundhe has cooked up a storm through his drive against violations of the Food Safety and Standards Act, 2006.

SPOTLIGHT.

Well-known establishments such as K Rustom Ice Cream Parlour and elite clubs, including the Cricket Club of India (CCI) in Mumbai, have not been spared.

Their food licences were suspended after recent inspections revealed significant issues, including pest infestations, unhygienic storage conditions, and other violations.

The man leading the mission is Mundhe, an IAS officer of the 2005 batch. Known for his no-nonsense attitude, uncompromising work style and campaign against illegalities, Mundhe is being dubbed ‘*Singham*’, an apparent reference to the Ajay Devgn movie of the same name, in which the protagonist takes on the mafia in Goa.

POLARISING FIGURE

But Mundhe’s working style has also made him a polarising figure. Loved by citizens, he has had run-ins with politicians in his earlier assignments.

As the civic chief of Nagpur during the Covid-19 pandemic, he faced allegations of corruption but was sub-

sequently given a clean chit.

Now, Mundhe, who has been transferred 25 times over two decades, has drawn the ire of his own staff. Twenty-nine officials from the FDA’s Chhatrapati Sambhajnagar district office have complained about his functioning to state FDA Minister Narhari Zirwal. The employees have alleged that they are being made to work extended hours, increasing the workload on the existing workforce.

While establishments like Parsi Dairy have resumed business after complying with norms, Poornima Restaurant in Fort has moved the court against FDA action. The Bombay High Court has also revoked the suspension of the licence of Navi Mumbai’s Park Inn by Radisson, as a re-inspection found 95 per cent compliance.

The court also asked the FDA whether it was inspecting canteens located within its own premises.

“Food safety is not about status. It is about standards. Wherever serious violations are found, FDA Maharashtra will act decisively to protect public health,” Mundhe wrote in an X post on July 29.

‘Govt to hold discussions with Meta on PM’s video glitch’

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The government will hold discussions with social media major Meta on policy and technical matters within a week over several concerns, including the removal of Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s Facebook post, a senior official at Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) said on Thursday.

“They will be coming and explaining what the situation is. We want to have both a policy-level and a technical understanding of the issues, and an adaptation to the kinds of concerns India has in this regard. There are several issues we have, which we will raise with them when they come. I think, within the next week, they will be coming,” S Krishnan, Secretary, MeitY, said.

META TO EXPLAIN

Speaking on the sidelines of the CII conference on semi-conductors, he that the government has asked Meta to explain the issue that led to the glitch.

The government summoned Meta’s public policy head after the PM’s



Facebook post, on July 23, addressing India’s youth and promising stringent measures against exam paper leaks, was briefly restricted by the US-headquartered social media giant.

CRACK DOWN

Modi’s July 23 Instagram post, later shared on Facebook, marked his first direct selfie video aimed at engaging with the youth and underscoring the government’s commitment to crack down on exam paper leaks amid students’ protests organised by the Cockroach Janta Party. The Facebook version of the post was briefly restricted by Meta before being restored.

Following the incident, the global head of public policy of Meta (Facebook and Instagram) was summoned by MeitY.

Meta, the owner of social media platform Facebook, is learnt to have written to the government outlining the

specifics of enhanced and rigorous safeguards it has now implemented for content posted by the Prime Minister and other prominent accounts.

While Meta attributed the incident to a technical glitch and apologised, MeitY has found the explanation “inadequate”.

The social media giant has now informed the Ministry that posts by the Prime Minister and select prominent accounts will be subject to additional oversight on the platform, with multiple levels of checks involving senior company officials.

Any decision will undergo rigorous checks and require review by at least two senior officials of the company, government sources said, citing the social media firm’s latest communication to MeitY.

CORRECTIVE ACTION

Meta has expressed regret over the incident, and explained the circumstances that led to it adding that the company has also outlined the corrective measures it has since implemented, and shared its assessment, sources have confirmed.

However, Krishnan said Meta has to give reasons on the cause that led to the incident.

Government to launch digital drug regulatory portal in 18 months

Ankita Upadhyay
New Delhi

The Central Drugs Standard Control Organisation (CDSCO) will roll out the first phase of an end-to-end digital drug regulatory platform within the next 18 months, Drugs Controller General of India (DCGI) Rajeev Singh Raghuvanshi announced at the inaugural Global Drug Regulatory Conclave (GDRC) 2026.

Raghuvanshi said the upcoming platform will integrate the entire pharmaceutical regulatory value chain, from research and clinical development to manufacturing, approvals, distribution, and post-market surveillance, into a single-digital ecosystem connecting regulators, manufacturers and other stakeholders.

REDUCING DELAYS

Raghuvanshi said that more than 99 per cent of CDSCO’s regulatory processes have already been digitised, improving transparency and reducing approval timelines.

He further said CDSCO is piloting artificial intelligence across regulatory processes to create a faster and more

data-driven regulatory system. GMP and Certificate of Pharmaceutical Product (COPP) certificates will soon feature QR-code-based digital authentication, allowing overseas regulators to instantly verify their authenticity and reducing verification delays.

Raghuvanshi said CDSCO has introduced a fully-digitised export no objection certificate (NOC) system, globally aligned regulatory reliance mechanisms, and accelerated approval pathways for innovative therapies.

“Around 25-30 per cent of clinical trials are currently being considered for waiver for eligible innovative products,” he said.

Speaking at the event, Namit Joshi, Chairman, Pharmexcil, said India’s position as the “pharmacy of the world” provides an opportunity to become a stronger global regulatory partner.

The two-day conclave focused on strengthening regulatory co-operation, advancing digital transformation, promoting regulatory science, and building resilient global healthcare supply chains to ensure timely access to affordable medicines.

Novartis India to be renamed as ChrysCapital buys parent stake

PT Jyothi Datta
Mumbai



Novartis India Limited will soon have a new name, as it gets recast with a new management team and builds on the legacy brands that remain in its basket.

This follows private equity firm ChrysCapital’s acquisition of the entire 70.68 per cent stake in Novartis India Limited (NIL), previously held by the parent company, Swiss drugmaker Novartis AG.

NIL had been put on the block after the parent company said in 2024 that its India-listed entity was under review. In an announcement in February this year, the transaction amount was pegged at ₹1,446 crore.

CORPORATE IDENTITY

The acquisition marks ChrysCapital’s first majority-controlled investment in the Indian pharmaceutical sector, the PE firm said. NIL will adopt a new name and corporate identity to mark its separation from its previous owners, it added.

The transaction brings a long-standing pharmaceutical businesses under “dedicated private equity ownership”, with the ambition to build a

branded-generics platform for the Indian market, the PE firm said.

NIL operates across therapeutic areas including pain management, calcium supplementation, gynaecology, neurosciences, and transplant immunology with brands including Voveran, Calcium Sandoz and Tegeral, to name a few. About 40 employees will move into this company, an industry-insider said, adding that operations will be built-up from scratch, even as it continues to rely on existing relationships for contract manufacturing. The company turnover for March 2026 stood at ₹354 crore.

NIL has appointed seasoned industry-hand Vikas Gupta as Chief Executive and Managing Director. Ramesh Ramadurai, Suchita Sharma and Shashank Sinha have joined as Independent Directors on NIL board, it said, as the top management

gets recast. Guptasaid in a statement, “We carry forward decades of scientific rigour and physician trust — from that strong foundation and with ChrysCapital’s backing we have the resources and focus to grow our portfolio with purpose, reach more patients, and build on what this organisation has always stood for.” Kshiti Sheth, Managing Director, ChrysCapital Advisors, added, NIL’s legacy brands and market standing combined with ChrysCapital laid the foundation “for long-term value creation”.

NOVARTIS IN INDIA

Novartis will continue to be present in India through Novartis Healthcare Private Limited (NHPL), a wholly-owned subsidiary through which the company has been bringing its high-value innovative products into India. Following the transaction, NHPL had said in an earlier statement, that it will now be a “pure-play innovative medicines company”, aligned with its global strategy — focused on its cardio-renal-metabolic and oncology products, for example. The transfer of Novartis AG shareholding in NIL will not impact NHPL, it had then said.

Banner, banter and Bengal’s ‘traitors’ in Parliament

Mamata loyalist Kalyan Banerjee’s unique protest created a moment of mirth

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The ruling BJP’s success in shrinking the opposition’s ranks may not yet have prompted soul-searching, but it has certainly triggered moments of dark humour and mirth in Parliament.

On Thursday, Trinamool Congress’s most loquacious MP, Kalyan Banerjee, arrived in the Parliament precincts draped in a giant banner carrying photographs of 20 Bengal MPs who have switched over to the BJP. The banner headline screamed: “Lok Sabha mein Bangal Ka 20 Gaddar (The 20 traitors from Bengal in the Lok Sabha)”.



TMC MP Kalyan Banerjee stages a protest as Congress MPs Priyanka Gandhi Vadra and others look on

As Banerjee posed for photographers, Priyanka Gandhi and a few other MPs, including Rajiv Ranjan, alias ‘Pappu’ Yadav from Bihar, Imran Masud from Uttar Pradesh *et al*, stopped to admire his handiwork.

“Par in mein se kaafi sare to hamare yahan se aapke

yahaan gaye aur phir BJP mein bhaag gaye (A whole lot of them were first with us before they joined you and then ran away to the BJP),” Gandhi told him with a smile.

Banerjee insisted that they may have come from the Congress, but they had won on the Trinamool Con-

gress ticket. At that, Pappu Yadav butted in, saying they were definitely turncoats from the Congress to begin with.

“The to Congressi (whatever you may say, they were with the Congress first),” Yadav said.

THE RETORT

“So what, even I was a Congressi. I was vice president of the Youth Congress,” Banerjee declared, to the laughing group of Congress MPs. Not stopping there, he advanced towards Gandhi, “Arre tum log Didi ko bhi bhaga diya (you people hounded Mamata Banerjee out of the Congress too). If you hadn’t turned her out in 1997, you wouldn’t have

been in this state,” he said.

But Gandhi was not about to let that pass. “*Didi ko Rajiv-ji bohut maante the* (Rajiv Gandhi respected Mamata Banerjee),” she said.

“You’re right about that. Rajiv-ji adored Didi. But you people...” he was about to launch into a tirade when Pappu Yadav again interrupted, saying, “*Sonia-ji also respected Didi.*”

“Arre Pappu Singh, you listen. These people (the Congress) went with the CPI-M. We were fighting with the CPI-M. They betrayed us,” said Banerjee, about to start another rant when a smiling Gandhi walked away, leaving behind a cluster of laughing MPs.

RPG Life to boost API business with Actis Generics acquisition

Our Bureau
Mumbai

In an effort to strengthen its active pharmaceutical ingredients (API) business, RPG Life Sciences Ltd has agreed to transfer its API business to RPG Active Pharma Ltd, even as it has announced plans to acquire Actis Generics Private Ltd — a Visakhapatnam-based API manufacturing company.

RPG LS said it had executed a business transfer agreement to shift its API business to a wholly-owned subsidiary — RPG Active Pharma Ltd — as a going concern on a slump sale basis. The proposed transfer is part of RPG LS’s strategy “to create a focused API busi-

ness with dedicated capital, sharper management attention and greater strategic flexibility, while the company also continues to build its formulations business,” it said. The development comes at a time when India is emerging as a destination for reliable, high-quality API manufacturing, it said.

INVESTMENT DEAL

The company has also entered into an investment agreement with Inv Ascent, a healthcare-focused private equity investor, through an investment in RPG Active Pharma, it said. Funds managed by InvAscent will make an initial investment of up to ₹243 crore in RPG Active Pharma, it added.

“The agreement envisages

investments by the company and InvAscent up to ₹700 crore in RPG AP in tranches. The investment is expected to provide RPG Active Pharma the capital and strategic support required to strengthen manufacturing infrastructure, expand the product portfolio, enhance process development capabilities and pursue organic and inorganic growth opportunities,” it added.

RPG Active Pharma has also executed a share purchase agreement to acquire 100 per cent equity in Actis Generics Private Ltd, the company said. RPG

LS management told *businessline* on Wednesday that the company was scouting for a manufacturing facility for APIs or formulations.

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52WH	52WL	PE	BSE CI	Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52WH	52WL	PE	BSE CI	Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52WH	52WL	PE	BSE CI	
Polyplex	1121.10	1103.45	1121.10	1128.75	1100.00	46.80	1179.95	74.30	58	1102.90	SKF Indl(Ind)	2667.60	2617.60	2679.90	2697.90	2647.60	20.45	304.00	1994.10	-	-	Viaya Diag	1372.00	1360.00	1369.10	1374.70	1351.10	55.89	1440.00	848.00	-	-	
Ponavalafin	482.00	476.90	484.00	482.00	475.00	82.33	547.00	361.20	-	-	SUN INDIA	1447.00	1447.00	1486.30	1493.30	1461.00	24.00	239.55	1404.00	25	1471.90	Vikas Eco [1]	1.11	1.09	1.11	1.12	1.10	10.97	2097.96	3.20	0.95	-	1.10
Power Grid	282.85	280.75	281.00	282.00	279.00	517.00	279.00	281.00	35.27	280.00	KIPPER [1]	57.00	57.00	57.00	57.00	57.00	57.00	57.00	57.00	57.00	57.00	Vikram Solar	181.62	176.60	181.62	181.62	175.00	121.25	247.00	90.75	162.10	-	-
Power Ind	282.85	280.75	281.00	282.00	279.00	517.00	279.00	281.00	35.27	280.00	SKY Gold	63.55	63.55	63.55	63.55	63.55	63.55	63.55	63.55	63.55	63.55	VikramEnergy	73.18	71.62	73.18	73.18	73.18	73.18	73.18	73.18	73.18	-	-
Power Ind	282.85	280.75	281.00	282.00	279.00	517.00	279.00	281.00	35.27	280.00	Smartwells	482.00	482.00	482.00	482.00	482.00	482.00	482.00	482.00	482.00	482.00	VINATQ [1]	1309.00	1296.40	1315.00	1315.00	1286.00	39.49	190.00	1204.00	27	1294.45	
Power Ind	282.85	280.75	281.00	282.00	279.00	517.00	279.00	281.00	35.27	280.00	SMC Glo.Hndr	80.03	81.54	79.90	82.60	78.60	14.18	151.72	54.44	-	-	Vindhya Tele	1885.20	1951.20	1890.00	1978.00	1860.00	36.89	2480.00	96.00	44	1953.05	
Power Ind	282.85	280.75	281.00	282.00	279.00	517.00	279.00	281.00	35.27	280.00	SML Mahindra	4566.00	5479.20	5024.00	5479.20	5020.00	14.95	35.20	247.90	2719.00	-	VINYVHEM [1]	246.05	238.05	246.05	246.05	235.00	81.21	325.00	160.05	35	237.25	
Power Ind	282.85	280.75	281.00	282.00	279.00	517.00	279.00	281.00	35.27	280.00	SMS Pharma [1]	336.75	374.65	395.55	399.55	372.00	33.90	44.65	208.20	-	Vip Indus. [2]	296.00	296.10	296.10	296.10	296.10	296.10	296.10	296.10	296.10	-	-	
Power Ind	282.85	280.75	281.00	282.00	279.00	517.00	279.00	281.00	35.27	280.00	Sonoma Ind	729.37	70.30	70.30	70.30	70.30	70.30	70.30	70.30	70.30	70.30	Virtuoso Opt	491.20	469.15	495.80	495.80	463.45	67.69	53.44	428.65	-	-	
Power Ind	282.85	280.75	281.00	282.00	279.00	517.00	279.00	281.00	35.27	280.00	SolarWorld	196.14	189.34	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	Vishal MegaM	108.24	107.88	108.24	108.24	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	-	-
Power Ind	282.85	280.75	281.00	282.00	279.00	517.00	279.00	281.00	35.27	280.00	Soletron	3578.50	3446.80	3578.50	3600.00	3413.30	29.91	391.00	2051.55	73	3441.20	Vishal MegaM	108.24	107.88	108.24	108.24	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	-	-
Power Ind	282.85	280.75	281.00	282.00	279.00	517.00	279.00	281.00	35.27	280.00	SolarWorld	196.14	189.34	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	Vishal MegaM	108.24	107.88	108.24	108.24	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	-	-
Power Ind	282.85	280.75	281.00	282.00	279.00	517.00	279.00	281.00	35.27	280.00	SolarWorld	196.14	189.34	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	Vishal MegaM	108.24	107.88	108.24	108.24	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	-	-
Power Ind	282.85	280.75	281.00	282.00	279.00	517.00	279.00	281.00	35.27	280.00	SolarWorld	196.14	189.34	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	Vishal MegaM	108.24	107.88	108.24	108.24	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	-	-
Power Ind	282.85	280.75	281.00	282.00	279.00	517.00	279.00	281.00	35.27	280.00	SolarWorld	196.14	189.34	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	Vishal MegaM	108.24	107.88	108.24	108.24	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	-	-
Power Ind	282.85	280.75	281.00	282.00	279.00	517.00	279.00	281.00	35.27	280.00	SolarWorld	196.14	189.34	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	Vishal MegaM	108.24	107.88	108.24	108.24	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	-	-
Power Ind	282.85	280.75	281.00	282.00	279.00	517.00	279.00	281.00	35.27	280.00	SolarWorld	196.14	189.34	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	Vishal MegaM	108.24	107.88	108.24	108.24	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	-	-
Power Ind	282.85	280.75	281.00	282.00	279.00	517.00	279.00	281.00	35.27	280.00	SolarWorld	196.14	189.34	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	Vishal MegaM	108.24	107.88	108.24	108.24	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	-	-
Power Ind	282.85	280.75	281.00	282.00	279.00	517.00	279.00	281.00	35.27	280.00	SolarWorld	196.14	189.34	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	Vishal MegaM	108.24	107.88	108.24	108.24	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	-	-
Power Ind	282.85	280.75	281.00	282.00	279.00	517.00	279.00	281.00	35.27	280.00	SolarWorld	196.14	189.34	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	Vishal MegaM	108.24	107.88	108.24	108.24	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	-	-
Power Ind	282.85	280.75	281.00	282.00	279.00	517.00	279.00	281.00	35.27	280.00	SolarWorld	196.14	189.34	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	Vishal MegaM	108.24	107.88	108.24	108.24	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	-	-
Power Ind	282.85	280.75	281.00	282.00	279.00	517.00	279.00	281.00	35.27	280.00	SolarWorld	196.14	189.34	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	Vishal MegaM	108.24	107.88	108.24	108.24	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	-	-
Power Ind	282.85	280.75	281.00	282.00	279.00	517.00	279.00	281.00	35.27	280.00	SolarWorld	196.14	189.34	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	Vishal MegaM	108.24	107.88	108.24	108.24	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	-	-
Power Ind	282.85	280.75	281.00	282.00	279.00	517.00	279.00	281.00	35.27	280.00	SolarWorld	196.14	189.34	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	Vishal MegaM	108.24	107.88	108.24	108.24	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	-	-
Power Ind	282.85	280.75	281.00	282.00	279.00	517.00	279.00	281.00	35.27	280.00	SolarWorld	196.14	189.34	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	Vishal MegaM	108.24	107.88	108.24	108.24	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	-	-
Power Ind	282.85	280.75	281.00	282.00	279.00	517.00	279.00	281.00	35.27	280.00	SolarWorld	196.14	189.34	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	Vishal MegaM	108.24	107.88	108.24	108.24	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	-	-
Power Ind	282.85	280.75	281.00	282.00	279.00	517.00	279.00	281.00	35.27	280.00	SolarWorld	196.14	189.34	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	Vishal MegaM	108.24	107.88	108.24	108.24	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	-	-
Power Ind	282.85	280.75	281.00	282.00	279.00	517.00	279.00	281.00	35.27	280.00	SolarWorld	196.14	189.34	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	Vishal MegaM	108.24	107.88	108.24	108.24	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	-	-
Power Ind	282.85	280.75	281.00	282.00	279.00	517.00	279.00	281.00	35.27	280.00	SolarWorld	196.14	189.34	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	Vishal MegaM	108.24	107.88	108.24	108.24	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	-	-
Power Ind	282.85	280.75	281.00	282.00	279.00	517.00	279.00	281.00	35.27	280.00	SolarWorld	196.14	189.34	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	Vishal MegaM	108.24	107.88	108.24	108.24	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	-	-
Power Ind	282.85	280.75	281.00	282.00	279.00	517.00	279.00	281.00	35.27	280.00	SolarWorld	196.14	189.34	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	Vishal MegaM	108.24	107.88	108.24	108.24	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	-	-
Power Ind	282.85	280.75	281.00	282.00	279.00	517.00	279.00	281.00	35.27	280.00	SolarWorld	196.14	189.34	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	Vishal MegaM	108.24	107.88	108.24	108.24	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	-	-
Power Ind	282.85	280.75	281.00	282.00	279.00	517.00	279.00	281.00	35.27	280.00	SolarWorld	196.14	189.34	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	Vishal MegaM	108.24	107.88	108.24	108.24	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	-	-
Power Ind	282.85	280.75	281.00	282.00	279.00	517.00	279.00	281.00	35.27	280.00	SolarWorld	196.14	189.34	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	196.14	Vishal MegaM	108.24	107.88	108.24	108.24	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	107.88	-	-